World survey – Europe north of the Mediterranean, and the Caucasus: ancient texts for Hebrew translation

▼ Contents

0. Key findings 2

1. Ranked shortlist 3

2. The survey 7

A. CELTIC 7

A1. Gaulish inscriptions (Larzac, Chamalières, Coligny, Châteaubleau, Orléans; also Gallo-Greek) 7

A2. Celtiberian and Lepontic 8

A3. Ogam inscriptions 8

A4. Lebor Gabála Érenn ("The Book of the Taking of Ireland") — reception of Gen 1–11 8

A5. Auraicept na nÉces (The Scholars' Primer); Sex Aetates Mundi; Saltair na Rann; In Tenga Bithnua; Fintan and the Hawk of Achill 9

A6. Táin Bó Cúailnge and the Ulster Cycle 9

A7. Mythological Cycle: Cath Maige Tuired (The Second Battle of Mag Tuired), Tochmarc Étaíne, Aislinge Óenguso, Metrical Dindshenchas 9

A8. Early Irish law (*Senchas Már*, *Críth Gablach*, *Bretha Crólige*, *Bechbretha*, *Cáin Lánamna*, *Uraicecht Becc*; with the *Liber ex lege Moysi*) 10

A9. Early Irish poetry: Amairgen's song, the Lament of the Old Woman of Beare, hermit and nature lyrics, gnomic texts (*Audacht Morainn*, *Tecosca Cormaic*, the Triads) 10

A10. Immram Brain, Echtrae, and Otherworld voyages 10

A11. The Four Branches of the Mabinogi (and other Middle Welsh prose) 11

A12. Early Welsh poetry: Book of Taliesin, Y Gododdin, Canu Llywarch Hen and Canu Heledd, Trioedd Ynys Prydein, Englynion y Beddau 11

B. GERMANIC 11

B1. The Poetic Edda: mythological poems (Völuspá, Hávamál, Vafþrúðnismál, Grímnismál, Hymiskviða, Þrymskviða, Lokasenna, Baldrs draumar, Rígsþula, Alvíssmál) 11

B2. Snorri's Prose Edda: Prologue and Gylfaginning (flag: learned systematization) 12

B3. Skaldic mythological poems (Bragi's Ragnarsdrápa, Þjóðólfr's Haustlǫng, Úlfr Uggason's Húsdrápa, Eilífr's Þórsdrápa) 13

B4. Runic inscriptions: Rök, Eggja, Gallehus, Björketorp, Viking-age runestones 13

B5. Old High German: Wessobrunn Prayer, Merseburg Charms, Muspilli, Hildebrandslied 13

B6. Beowulf (with Widsith, Deor, Maxims I–II, Cædmon's Hymn) 14

B7. Old English metrical charms: Æcerbot, Nine Herbs Charm, Wið færstice, and others 15

B8. Gothic (Wulfila), Old Saxon, Old English biblical poetry: out of scope, but mention 15

C. BALTIC 15

C1. Latvian dainas (*Latvju dainas*) 15

C2. Lithuanian *dainos*, *raudos* (laments) and *sutartinės*; Old Prussian 16

D. SLAVIC 16

D1. Russian byliny, the Dove Book (*Golubinaya kniga*) and the North-Russian laments 16

D2. Primary Chronicle (*Povest' vremennykh let*), opening: the Table of Nations 16

D3. Other Slavic material 16

E. CROSS-REGIONAL RECEPTION DOSSIER 17

E1. "The Table of Nations in the North and the Caucasus": medieval peoples writing themselves into Gen 10–11 17

F. FINNIC AND SÁMI 17

F1. Finnic "old runes": SKVR (*Suomen Kansan Vanhat Runot*) 17

F2. Estonian *regilaul* (runosongs) 18

F3. Sámi: yoik, myths, and missionary reports 18

G. BASQUE 18

H. CAUCASUS 19

H1. Ossetian Nart sagas (*Narty kaddžytæ*) 19

H2. Circassian (Adyghe/Kabardian) and Abkhaz Nart sagas 19

H3. Georgian Amirani 19

H4. Armenian: Movses Khorenatsi's pagan song-fragments and the epic *Sasna Tsrer* (Daredevils of Sasun / David of Sasun) 19

3. Also considered (one line each) 20

4. Access notes (tested 2026-10-21 from this session) 21

5. Sources consulted 22

Prepared 2026-10-21 for `שונות/תרגומי-טקסטים-קדומים/`. Part of the world survey (one file per region).
Region: Celtic (Gaulish, Celtiberian, Lepontic, Ogam, Old/Middle Irish, Middle Welsh), Germanic (Old Norse, runic, Old English, Old High German, Gothic), Baltic, Slavic, Finnic and Sámi, Basque, and the Caucasus (Ossetian, Circassian/Abkhaz, Georgian, Armenian).
Legend: **verified** = fetched today (2026-10-21) from this session and saw the expected content; **reported** = from search results or my own knowledge, not fetched. Bible benefit and Soul benefit are each rated HIGH / MED-HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW.
Raw fetches are cached in `/tmp/claude-0/-home-user-perush/009325a3-391a-55eb-9c0e-32e1e254e6c6/scratchpad/world/europe-north-caucasus/`.

Nothing was executed from them.

Search budget. The session-wide WebSearch limit ran out partway through. Later bibliographic details come from my own knowledge, and the less certain ones are marked "verify".

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0. Key findings

1. **Almost nothing here is ancient in the Near Eastern sense.** Only a handful of texts are actually written in antiquity:
   - Gaulish lead tablets and the Coligny calendar (1st–2nd c. CE);
   - Celtiberian bronzes (c. 100 BCE);
   - early runic inscriptions (from c. 200 CE) and Ogam (4th–7th c.).

   They are short, and except for the runes they are only partly understood. Everything else was written down by Christians: in Ireland from c. 700, Iceland after 1200, Wales after 1250. Finnic, Baltic, Slavic and Caucasian oral poetry was collected only in 1564–1950.

   So the real question for every text is **how much pre-Christian tradition it preserves, and how we know**. Scholars use six controls:
   - comparison with other Indo-European traditions. Shared formulas cannot be borrowed: Wessobrunn / Völuspá 3 / Rigveda 10.129 "there was neither earth nor heaven above"; Merseburg II "bone to bone" ↔ Atharvaveda 4.12; the Latvian *Dieva dēli* ↔ the Vedic Aśvins;
   - cross-Celtic name equations: Lugus = Irish Lug = Welsh Lleu; Manannán mac Lir = Manawydan fab Llŷr; Maponos = Mabon;
   - independent classical witnesses: Caesar *BG* 6.13–18 on the druids; Tacitus *Germania* 2 on Tuisto and Mannus; Herodotus 4.5–10 on Scythian origins (↔ the Ossetian Narts);
   - pre-conversion images: Thor fishing for the World Serpent on the Altuna stone and at Gosforth; the Gallehus horns;
   - linguistic dating of archaic forms in late manuscripts;
   - the Christian marks themselves, which can be identified and peeled off.
2. **Best overall candidate: the Finnic "old runes", SKVR** (*Suomen Kansan Vanhat Runot*). It holds **89,247 oral poems recorded 1564–1939**, under **CC BY 4.0**. I verified the licence in the official GitHub README, and that a 128 MB zip of one TEI file per poem downloads from finlit.fi.
   - It has world creation from a bird's egg, the felling of the Great Oak, the Sampo, and the *synnyt* (origin-incantations).
   - The bird nesting on the primeval sea is a strong typological control for Gen 1:2 *meraḥefet* (cf. Deut 32:11). The egg's halves becoming heaven and earth, with yolk and white becoming sun and moon, is a control for Gen 1:6–16.
   - It is open, very large, and Finnish is LLM-friendly. The Karelian/Ingrian dialect texts are harder.
   - It is distinct from Lönnrot's *Kalevala* (1835/1849), a 19th-century composition built from these runes.
3. **The Poetic Edda** (Codex Regius GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270) is the region's richest single book for both purposes. Base texts are public domain and **verified online**: Bugge 1867 at etext.old.no; Finnur Jónsson's edition at Septentrionalia; Guðni Jónsson's normalized text at heimskringla.no.
   - The tools are excellent: Cleasby–Vigfusson and Zoëga (public domain), ONP, and the free Viking Society PDFs (Evans' *Hávamál*, Faulkes' Snorri).
   - **Völuspá** gives control after control: a void before creation (st. 3) ↔ Gen 1:2 / 2:5; lands raised from the sea (st. 4) ↔ Gen 1:9; the gods naming night and the moon's phases (st. 6) ↔ Gen 1:5, 14; Askr and Embla "without breath (*ǫnd*)", given breath by Óðinn (st. 17–18) ↔ Gen 2:7; the earth rising "a second time out of the sea, ever-green" (st. 59) ↔ Gen 8.
   - **Hymiskviða** (Thor hooks the World Serpent) ↔ Job 40:25, Isa 27:1, Ps 74:13–14, and so Gen 1:21 *ha-tanninim*, the unit now being written.
   - **Hávamál** ↔ Proverbs and Ecclesiastes.
4. **A small, cheap, very high-value Germanic dossier: the "when there was neither earth nor heaven" formula.** It brings together:
   - the Old High German **Wessobrunn Prayer** (Clm 22053, c. 814; verified on Wikisource);
   - **Völuspá 3**;
   - **Cædmon's Hymn** and the creation song in *Beowulf* 90–98;
   - typological controls from outside the region: Rigveda 10.129, *Enūma eliš* I 1–2, and Gen 2:4b–5.

   This is the best place in the region to see one inherited Indo-European cosmogonic formula meet Genesis. Add the **Merseburg Charms** (pre-Christian gods, 10th-c. ms; "bone to bone" ↔ Ezek 37:7) and **Muspilli** (a Christian apocalypse that reuses a pagan word for the world-fire).
5. **The region's real strength for Gen 8:20–11:26, which has no commentary yet, is reception.** These are Christian learned pseudo-histories that wrote their peoples into Genesis 10–11. Together they form a "Table of Nations dossier":
   - the Irish **Lebor Gabála Érenn**: the Flood, the sons of Japheth, Fénius Farsaid at the Tower, Goídel healed by Moses' rod ↔ Num 21:8–9;
   - the Irish grammar **Auraicept na nÉces**: Irish assembled from the 72 languages after Babel;
   - the Old East Slavic **Primary Chronicle**: it opens with the division of the earth among Noah's sons;
   - **Movses Khorenatsi**: Hayk son of Torgom/Togarmah rebels against Bel/Nimrod after the Tower;
   - **Leonti Mroveli**: Targamos/Togarmah (Gen 10:3), father of the Caucasian peoples;
   - **Snorri's Prologue**: the Flood, then the Æsir as men of Asia.

   None of it is ancient, but it shows exactly which features of Gen 10–11 medieval readers found productive. That is a useful control for a word-by-word commentary, and it should be labelled honestly as reception, not source.

6. **Early Irish law** (*Senchas Már*, c. 650–750; *Críth Gablach*; *Bretha Crólige*; *Bechbretha*) is the most interesting legal material north of the Alps.
   - It has honour-price and body-price (cf. Ex 21:30 *kofer*, against Num 35:31); sick-maintenance (*Bretha Crólige*, cf. Ex 21:18–19 "he shall pay for his loss of time and have him thoroughly healed"); sanctuary (*maigen*, cf. Ex 21:13–14); distraint (cf. Deut 24:10–13).
   - Old Testament influence is itself part of the story. The *Liber ex lege Moysi* (c. 700) is an Irish excerpt-book of Mosaic law, and the "nativist vs anti-nativist" debate (Binchy vs McCone and Ó Corráin) is about exactly this.
   - **But** the base text (Binchy's *Corpus Iuris Hibernici*, 1978) is copyrighted and untranslated, and archaic legal Old Irish is among the hardest material in the survey for an LLM. Feasibility is low unless the work is limited to tracts with modern DIAS editions.
7. **CELT (celt.ucc.ie) is up and verified**, with the Táin Recension I (47,230 words), the Book of Leinster Táin, *Cath Maige Tuired* (Gray and Stokes), the Metrical Dindshenchas, *Auraicept*, *Saltair na Rann* and more. But every file is marked **"[RESTRICTED] Available with prior consent of the CELT programme for purposes of academic research and teaching only"** (verified in the TEI headers). Use it for reading, and do not commit it to the public repo.
   - Public-domain alternatives exist for many texts: Stokes, Meyer, Windisch, Calder and Gwynn editions (pre-1940 editors).
   - eDIL (dil.ie) answered **503 "No server is available"** all day. That is an outage at the origin, not a proxy block.
8. **The Celtic and Caucasian heroic and mythic material is a window on the ancient mind, more than a Bible control.** This covers the Táin and the Ulster cycle, *Cath Maige Tuired*, the Mabinogi, the Ossetian Narts, Sasna Tsrer and Amirani. It is excellent for the "soul" purpose, with low to medium Bible value.
   - The "window on the Iron Age" view of the Táin (Jackson 1964) is now largely rejected: its material culture is early-medieval (Mallory 2016).
   - The Caucasian corpora are weakly resourced for an LLM (Ossetian low–medium; Adyghe, Kabardian and Abkhaz very low) and poorly available online. Do not translate them from Russian intermediaries.
9. **Gaulish is rated "partly understood".** Grammar and roughly half the vocabulary of the longer texts are secure; whole clauses of Larzac and Chamalières are disputed. RIIG (riig.huma-num.fr), the online corpus of Gaulish inscriptions, **reset our connection** (blocked). Use these texts as a short annotated appendix of "the only Celtic words written in antiquity", not as an LLM translation project.
   - A new Gaulish text, the Orléans curse tablet to *Mars Rigisamus*, was excavated in 2022 and published 2023–25 (reported).
10. **Existing Hebrew translations** (for comparison, not use):
    - Tchernichovsky's **Kalevala, selections** (vol. 4 of his collected works, 1930, "from Finnish via German"). Verified in the Ben-Yehuda lexicon bibliography; this is Lönnrot's text, not SKVR.
    - Tchernichovsky's **"מן האדה האיסלנדית"**, which contains *Baldrs draumar* and *Alvíssmál* (in כוכבי שמים רחוקים, 1940–43). Verified on Ben-Yehuda.
    - **Arieh Stav, *שירת הצפון: מבחר האדה האיסלנדית*** (Arieh Nir, 2009, c. 560 pp.: most of the Poetic Edda, plus skaldic verse). Reported.
    - Stav also put a *Beowulf*, *The Lay of Igor* and a Kosovo cycle online as PDFs (reported; his site poetrytrans.com answered 503).
    - **I found no Hebrew Mabinogion, Táin, Nart sagas, dainas, byliny or Sasna Tsrer.** National Library of Israel (NLI) check advised.
11. **Hoaxes and constructions to keep out:**
    - Macpherson's *Ossian*; the *Oera Linda Book*; the *Book of Veles*; the Czech Králové Dvůr and Zelená Hora manuscripts (incl. the fake "Libuše's Judgment");
    - Iolo Morganwg's *Barddas* and the "Third Series" triads; the Basque "Song of Altabiskar" and the Iruña-Veleia graffiti; the Kensington Runestone; Simon Grunau's Prussian pantheon;
    - the literary epics *Kalevala*, *Kalevipoeg* and *Lāčplēsis*, which are not records of tradition;
    - Lebor Gabála read as history.

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1. Ranked shortlist

Ranked on both purposes together, weighted by feasibility from the original language with open tools.

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
1	**Finnic runes (SKVR), mythic and origin songs**: World Creation, Great Oak, Sampo, Väinämöinen in Tuonela, *synnyt*	Finnish, Karelian, Ingrian, Votic · Kalevala meter likely 1st mill. CE or older (debated) · recorded 1564–1939	89,247 texts; select c. 50–150 key variants · excellent	Gen 1:2 (*meraḥefet*, the bird on the sea), 1:6–16 (egg → heaven, earth, sun, moon); Deut 32:11	magic of "knowing the origin", shamanic journey, the singer's world	MED-HIGH / HIGH	**SKVR, CC BY 4.0, verified** (zip + GitHub)	**HIGH** (Finnish good; dialects medium)
2	**Poetic Edda, mythological poems**: Völuspá, Vafþrúðnismál, Grímnismál, Hávamál, Hymiskviða, Þrymskviða, Baldrs draumar, Rígsþula, Lokasenna	Old Norse · 9th–12th c. (Völuspá c. 1000, debated) · Codex Regius c. 1270, Hauksbók c. 1300–10	c. 3,000 long-lines for these (whole Edda c. 7,000) · excellent	Gen 1:2, 1:5–14, 1:21 (World Serpent), 2:7 (Askr/Embla), 2:9 (world tree), 7–8 (renewal); Proverbs; Deut 22:5 (Þrymskviða)	fate, death and fame, wisdom, humour	MED-HIGH / HIGH	**PD, verified** (Bugge 1867, Finnur Jónsson, heimskringla.no)	**HIGH**
3	**"When there was not" dossier**: Wessobrunn Prayer, Völuspá 3–4, Cædmon's Hymn, *Beowulf* 90–98, plus Merseburg Charms and Muspilli	OHG, ON, OE · formula Indo-European; mss c. 814 (Wessobrunn), 9th–10th c.	c. 200 lines in all · excellent	**Gen 1:1–2, 2:4b–5**; Ezek 37:7 (Merseburg); Gen 3:15	prayer, charm, end of the world	**HIGH** (short) / MED-HIGH	**PD, verified** (de.wikisource, Titus mirror, Bosworth–Toller)	**HIGH**
4	**Beowulf** (+ Widsith, Deor, Maxims I–II)	Old English · c. 700–1000 (debated) · Cotton Vitellius A.xv, c. 1000	3,182 lines · good (fire damage at the edges)	**Gen 4:8–16** (Cain's kin), **6:4** (giants), **6–7** (flood on the sword-hilt, 1688–93), 1:1–18 (lines 90–98)	heroic ethic, the hall, grief, fate	MED-HIGH / HIGH	PD older editions; Electronic Beowulf free online (©), verified	**HIGH**
5	**Table-of-Nations reception dossier**: Lebor Gabála (Gen 1–11 sections), Auraicept na nÉces (Babel), Primary Chronicle opening, Movses Khorenatsi I.5–12, Leonti Mroveli, Snorri's Prologue	Middle Irish, Old East Slavic, Classical Armenian, Old Georgian, Old Norse · 8th–13th c.	excerpts, c. 5–15k words · good	**Gen 6–11** (10:2–5, 10:3 Togarmah, 10:8–12 Nimrod, 11:1–9), Num 21:8–9	how peoples saw their own origins	**HIGH** (reception) / MEDIUM	mixed: Macalister (PD in the EU since 2021, verify), Calder 1917 PD, PSRL PD, Thomson ©	MEDIUM

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
6	**Old English charms**: Æcerbot, Nine Herbs Charm, Wið færstice	OE · pre-Christian core, Christian frame · 10th–11th-c. mss (Lacnunga, Harley 585)	c. 250 lines · good	Gen 3:15, 3:17–19 (curse of the ground reversed); Deut 28:4	"Erce, earth's mother": peasant religion	MEDIUM / HIGH	PD (ASPR 6, Storms 1948 — verify status)	HIGH
7	**Early Irish law**: Bretha Crólige, Críth Gablach, Bechbretha, Cáin Lánamna + *Liber ex lege Moysi* (Latin)	Old Irish · c. 650–750 · mss 14th–16th c. with heavy glosses	c. 15–30k words for these · good text, very hard language	**Ex 21:12–14, 18–19, 28–36, 22:1–14**, Num 35, Deut 24:10–13	status, honour, kinship, care of the sick	MED-HIGH / HIGH	CIH 1978 ©; ALI 1865–1901 PD (bad translations); DIAS editions ©	LOW-MEDIUM
8	**Russian byliny + the Dove Book (*Golubinaya kniga*) + North-Russian laments**	Russian (folk) · Kievan setting 10th–12th c., form later · Kirsha Danilov ms c. 1740s–60s; 19th-c. collections	thousands of texts; select c. 20 · good	Dove Book: Gen 1–2 (man from 8 parts, via 2 Enoch 30), the earth on a whale ↔ **Gen 1:21**; giants (Svyatogor) ↔ Gen 6:4	dragon-fights, laments (Fedosova)	MEDIUM / HIGH	PD 19th-c. editions; FEB (feb-web.ru) verified	HIGH
9	**Mythological Cycle**: Cath Maige Tuired, Tochmarc Étaíne, Aislinge Óenguso, selected Metrical Dindshenchas	Old/Middle Irish · 9th–12th c. (CMT has a 9th-c. core) · Harley 5280 (16th c.), LU, YBL	CMT c. 9–10k words · good	weak (Lug as master of every art; Dian Cécht's healing well ↔ Ex 15:26, typological)	the gods as Irish monks remembered them	LOW-MED / HIGH	Stokes 1891 PD; CELT restricted (verified)	MEDIUM (OI hard)
10	**Ulster Cycle**: Táin Bó Cúailnge I, Scéla Mucce Meic Dathó, Longes mac nUislenn, Aided Óenfir Aífe	Old Irish · 8th–9th c. language, 11th-c. redaction · LU c. 1100, LL c. 1160	Táin I 47k words (CELT) · good	Aided Óenfir Aífe ↔ Gen 22 (father kills son; typological); little else	heroic honour, wit, *geis*	LOW / HIGH	Windisch 1905, Strachan–O'Keeffe PD; O'Rahilly © (CELT restricted)	MEDIUM-LOW
11	**Four Branches of the Mabinogi** (+ Canu Llywarch Hen and Canu Heledd; Welsh triads)	Middle Welsh · c. 1060–1200 (debated) · Peniarth 6 fragments (13th c.), White Book c. 1350, Red Book c. 1400	c. 25k words (verify) · excellent	Blodeuedd made of flowers for a man ↔ Gen 2:21–22; triads ↔ Prov 30 numerical sayings	marriage, shame, enchantment, lament	LOW-MED / HIGH	PD diplomatic editions (Evans 1887/1907; reported); Williams 1930 ©	MEDIUM

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
12	**Latvian dainas, mythological and life-cycle songs** (Saule, Dievs, *Dieva dēli*, Mēness, Laima; orphans, weddings, death)	Latvian · motifs Indo-European, quatrains recorded 1770–1915 · Barons, *Latvju dainas* 1894–1915	c. 218,000 texts incl. variants; select c. 300 quatrains · excellent	Gen 1:14–18 (personified luminaries vs. Genesis' unnamed "lights")	sun-mother, orphan's grief, fate	LOW-MED / HIGH	LD PD (reported); dainuskapis.lv Cloudflare-blocked; korpuss.lv verified	MEDIUM
13	**Ossetian Nart sagas**	Iron/Digor Ossetian · Scythian–Alan roots (Dumézil), recorded 1840s–1940s	c. 90–200 tales · good	Gen 6:4 "men of renown", 11:4 "let us make us a name" (the Narts choose eternal fame and perish)	heroic ethos, Satana the matriarch	MEDIUM / HIGH	Miller 1881–87 PD (reported); modern editions © and not online	LOW
14	**Skaldic mythological poems**: Ragnarsdrápa, Haustlǫng, Húsdrápa, Þórsdrápa	Old Norse · 9th–10th c. (datable) · in Snorri's Edda, 13th–14th c. mss	c. 150 stanzas · fair	Thor and the Serpent ↔ Job 40:25, Gen 1:21	the oldest dated Norse myth	MEDIUM / MEDIUM	Finnur Jónsson *Skjaldedigtning* PD, verified (Septentrionalia)	MEDIUM (kennings)
15	**Snorri's Prose Edda**: Prologue + Gylfaginning (flag: a 1220s learned systematization)	Old Norse · c. 1220–25 · Codex Regius of SnE c. 1300–25	c. 20k words · excellent	Prologue: Gen 1–11 reception; Ymir's body ↔ Enūma eliš (typological)	the whole myth-world as told by a Christian scholar	MEDIUM / MED-HIGH	Faulkes (Viking Society, free PDF ©), Finnur Jónsson PD, verified	HIGH
16	**Armenian: Movses Khorenatsi's pagan fragments + Sasna Tsrer**	Classical Armenian (Movses, 5th or 8th c.); Mush/Sasun dialect (epic, recorded from 1873)	fragments c. 30 lines; epic c. 160 variants · good	Movses: Gen 8:4 (Ararat/Masis), 10–11 (Hayk vs Bel); epic: 2 Kgs 19:37 (Sennacherib's sons flee to Ararat), Egypt as the enemy (Msr)	birth of Vahagn, the hero sealed in the rock	MED-HIGH / HIGH	mixed; little open (Thomson ©)	MEDIUM-LOW
17	**Georgian Amirani**	Georgian (folk) · pre-Greek Caucasian core claimed (Charachidzé), recorded 19th–20th c.	c. 100+ variants · good	Gen 6:1–4 via 1 Enoch 10 (the bound rebel), Isa 14	the chained titan, smiths' rites	MEDIUM / MED-HIGH	Soviet editions ©, not online	LOW

#	Text	Language · date (composition / oral) · earliest ms	Size · condition	Bible focus (verses)	Soul focus	Bible / Soul	Base text (open?)	Feasibility
18	**Gaulish corpus**: Larzac, Chamalières, Coligny, Châteaubleau, Orléans (+ Botorrita I, Celtiberian)	Gaulish/Celtiberian · 1st c. BCE–2nd c. CE · the originals themselves	Larzac c. 160 words; Coligny dozens of fragments · fragmentary	weak (calendar ↔ Gen 1:14; curse ↔ Num 5)	women's magic, healing spring, calendar	LOW / MEDIUM	RIG (©), RIIG blocked	**LOW** (language half-understood)
19	**Estonian regilaul creation songs** (*Loomislaul*, *Suur tamm*)	Estonian incl. Seto · Finnic meter · 19th–20th c.	92,134 texts in the database (reported)	Gen 1:2 bird/egg	women's songs	MEDIUM / HIGH	ERAB/folklore.ee blocked; licence unknown	LOW-MEDIUM
20	**Runic corpus**: Rök, Eggja, Gallehus, Björketorp, Elder Futhark selection	Proto-Norse / Old Norse · c. 200–1050 CE · **originals**	Rök c. 760 runes · fair–good	weak	the dead and their memorial	LOW / MEDIUM	Rundata (ODbL/DbCL, reported); Runor (JS app) verified 200	MEDIUM

Runners-up (see §2 and §3): the Old Irish nature and hermit poems and the Lament of the Old Woman of Beare; *Immram Brain*; *Saltair na Rann* (Irish retelling of Gen 1–4); the *Book of Taliesin*; *Y Gododdin*; Lithuanian *raudos* (laments); Circassian and Abkhaz Narts; Sámi yoiks (Sirma 1673) and myths; Primary Chronicle (in item 5).

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2. The survey

A. CELTIC

A1. Gaulish inscriptions (Larzac, Chamalières, Coligny, Châteaubleau, Orléans; also Gallo-Greek)

Gaulish (Celtic) · written 1st c. BCE – 2nd c. CE · the originals survive · c. 1,000 inscriptions in all, mostly names; c. 6–10 "texts" with sentences · fragmentary

- *What it is.*
  - **Larzac** (L'Hospitalet-du-Larzac, found 1983; c. 90–110 CE). A lead tablet in two pieces, with c. 1,000 letters and c. 160 words, the longest Gaulish text. It is a binding spell against, or of, a group of women magicians ("Severa Tertionicna" and others). It sits in a woman's grave.
  - **Chamalières** (found 1971; c. 1st c. CE). A lead tablet of 12 lines and c. 336 letters, invoking *Maponos arueriíatis* at a healing spring full of wooden ex-votos.
  - **Coligny calendar** (late 2nd c. CE). A bronze plaque in dozens of fragments. It sets out a five-year lunisolar cycle of 62 months plus 2 intercalary months: *Samonios*, *Giamonios*, … The days are marked MAT ("good") / ANM ("not good"), with festival notations.
  - **Châteaubleau** tile (c. 2nd–3rd c.), with c. 11 lines, possibly about a marriage or courtship.
  - **Orléans 2022**: a Latin curse tablet with Gaulish words, to *Mars Rigisamus*. Reported, after Lambert; publicized 2023–25.
  - Also the Gallo-Greek dedications (RIG I) and the Alise-Sainte-Reine "Martialis" dedication.
- *Bible parallels.* Weak. A calendar of good and bad days is a typological control for Gen 1:14 (*le-moʿadim*) and Lev 23. A curse tablet placed in a grave can be compared with Num 5:23 (writing a curse and dissolving it). Neither is a textual link.
- *Soul.* Real ancient voices: women's magic, the healing god Maponos, a priestly time-reckoning. These are the only Celtic sentences written by the people who still worshipped these gods.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **RIG** (*Recueil des inscriptions gauloises*): vol. I (Gallo-Greek), II.1–2 (Etruscan/Latin script; II.2 = Lambert 2002 with Larzac and Chamalières), III (calendars, Duval & Pinault 1986), IV (coins). All copyrighted, in print.
  - **RIIG** (riig.huma-num.fr, ANR project 2020–24): an online EpiDoc edition. **Connection reset today (blocked).**
  - Lexicon Leponticum (univie): 503.
  - Tools: Delamarre, *Dictionnaire de la langue gauloise* (2003, ©); Lambert, *La langue gauloise* (2nd ed. 2003); Mees, *Celtic Curses* (2009).
  - **Hebrew: none.**

- *Feasibility and risks.* The language is only **partly understood**: the morphology is largely known, but much of the vocabulary and syntax of Larzac and Chamalières is disputed, and editions differ by whole clauses. An LLM "translation" would be a stitched-together paraphrase of competing readings. Present it at most as an annotated dossier that sets the readings of Lambert, Mees and others side by side.
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW / Soul MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* a short appendix ("the oldest Celtic words") once RIIG is reachable; not a translation project.

A2. Celtiberian and Lepontic

Celtiberian · c. 150–50 BCE · bronze originals · Botorrita I c. 200 words, Botorrita III c. 250 names, IV short; tesserae hospitales (hospitality tokens); Peñalba de Villastar rock inscription to Lugus

- What it is: Botorrita I is a bronze plaque that seems to regulate a sacred or communal area, with prohibitions and fines. It is understood only in outline.
- The tesserae are bronze tokens of hospitality pacts, typologically interesting for covenant (Gen 26:28–31, 31:44–54).
- Lepontic (northern Italy, 6th–1st c. BCE) consists of names and short dedications.
- Base text: *Monumenta Linguarum Hispanicarum* IV (Untermann 1997, ©). The Hesperia database (hesperia.ucm.es) **reset today**.
- LLM risk: **very high**. *Benefit:* LOW / LOW-MED. *Recommendation:* mention only; perhaps one note on the *tesserae* as a covenant analogue.

A3. Ogam inscriptions

Primitive Irish · 4th–7th c. CE · c. 400 stones (Ireland, Britain, Man) · names only ("X MAQI Y", "X son of Y")

- The oldest Irish, but formulaic memorial and boundary names. Genealogical formulas could be compared with *toledot* (Gen 5, 11:10–26) only in the loosest way.
- **OG(H)AM digital corpus (ogham.celt.dias.ie) is verified 200**: EpiDoc, 3D models, project 2021–25. (www.ogham.celt.dias.ie is blocked; use the bare host.)
- *Benefit:* LOW / LOW. *Recommendation:* exclude as a text; cite as background.

A4. Lebor Gabála Érenn ("The Book of the Taking of Ireland") — reception of Gen 1–11

Middle Irish prose and verse · compiled 11th c. (first recension c. 1060–1100), from poems by Eochaid ua Flainn (d. 1004), Flann Mainistrech (d. 1056) and others; an early form of the origin legend is in the *Historia Brittonum* (829/30) · earliest ms Book of Leinster (c. 1160); four or five recensions · large (Macalister's 5 vols, c. 1,300 pp. with translation) · well preserved but textually tangled

- *What it is.* A Christian synthetic pseudo-history.
  - It starts with Creation, Adam, Cain and Seth, and the Flood.
  - **Cessair**, granddaughter of Noah, reaches Ireland before the Flood; all her people drown except **Fintan mac Bóchra**, who survives as salmon, eagle and hawk.
  - Then come the waves of settlers, traced to **Magog son of Japheth** (Gen 10:2): Partholón, Nemed, the Fir Bolg, the **Tuatha Dé Danann** (the euhemerized gods; in some versions fallen angels), and the Milesians.
  - **Fénius Farsaid** is at the Tower of Nimrod. His grandson **Goídel Glas** is bitten by a serpent and healed by Moses' rod (cf. Num 21:8–9), which is why Ireland has no snakes. **Nél** marries **Scota**, Pharaoh's daughter, and refuses to join the pursuit of Israel (cf. Ex 14).
- *Bible parallels.* Direct, deliberate **reception of Gen 6–11 and the Exodus**: the Table of Nations (Gen 10:2–5, with Isidore, *Etymologiae* IX), Babel (11:1–9), the Flood chronology, Ex 14, Num 21. For a commentary with nothing yet on Gen 8:20–11:26, it shows exactly which features of Gen 10–11 a medieval reader found worth expanding: Japheth's line, the 72 languages, the Tower as the birthplace of languages.
  - Consensus: the biblical frame is accepted as learned construction (Carey 1994, *The Irish National Origin-Legend: Synthetic Pseudohistory*; Scowcroft, *Ériu* 38–39, 1987–88).
  - Pre-Christian residue is debated. It probably survives in the Tuatha Dé names and in the Amairgen poems, much less in the frame.
- *Soul.* Mostly the soul of 11th-c. Irish scholars: their need to place Ireland in sacred history. Fintan, the survivor who remembers everything, is a haunting figure.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - Macalister, *Lebor Gabála Érenn*, Irish Texts Society 34, 35, 39, 41, 44 (1938–56), Irish + English. Macalister died in 1950, so his own text is presumably **public domain in the EU/Ireland since 2021**. Verify the ITS position and vol. 5's other contributors. His edition is widely criticized: it conflates recensions and translates loosely.
  - CELT has only Michael Murphy's online index (celt.ucc.ie/indexLG.html, LGintro.pdf; reported).
  - Carey, *A New Introduction to Lebor Gabála Érenn* (ITS 1993).
  - eDIL for vocabulary (down today).
  - **Hebrew: none.**
- *Feasibility and risks.* Middle Irish is somewhat easier than Old Irish (risk MEDIUM-HIGH). The textual tangle means translating one recension's biblical sections (the prologue and the Cessair, Partholón and Fénius sections) from Macalister, with the variants flagged.
- *Benefit:* Bible **HIGH** (as reception, Gen 6–11) / Soul MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* translate the Gen 1–11 sections as the anchor of a "Table of Nations reception" dossier (§2 item E1).

A5. Auraicept na nÉces (The Scholars' Primer); Sex Aetates Mundi; Saltair na Rann; In Tenga Bithnua; Fintan and the Hawk of Achill

Old and Middle Irish · 7th–11th c. · various mss · CELT: Auraicept 73,125 words (Calder 1917, "the printed edition is now in the free domain", verified); Saltair na Rann 38,800 words (Stokes 1883, PD); Sex Aetates Mundi 2,250; Fintan and the Hawk 4,240 (Meyer, PD)

- **Auraicept**: after the confusion of tongues, Fénius Farsaid and his school build Irish (*bérla tóbaide*, "the selected language") from the best of the 72 languages. This is a direct gloss on Gen 11:1–9, and probably the most interesting medieval European commentary on Babel.
- **Saltair na Rann** (c. 988, verify): 150 cantos retelling sacred history. It covers creation, the angels' fall, Adam and Eve's penance standing in the rivers (from the *Vita Adae et Evae*) and Cain. It is apocrypha-laden reception of Gen 1–4.
- ***In Tenga Bithnua*** (The Evernew Tongue; Carey 2009, CCSA, ©): cosmology and the marvels of creation spoken by the Apostle Philip's tongue. Gen 1.
- *Bible:* HIGH as reception (Gen 1–4, 11). *Soul:* MEDIUM (monastic learning).
- LLM risk MEDIUM-HIGH. Public-domain base texts exist (Calder, Stokes, Meyer).
- *Recommendation:* include the Auraicept's Babel chapter and the *Saltair*'s Adam cantos (Greene & Kelly 1976, DIAS ©, for checking) in the reception dossier.

A6. Táin Bó Cúailnge and the Ulster Cycle

Old Irish (8th–9th-c. language) with Middle Irish layers · Recension I in Lebor na hUidre (LU, before 1106) and the Yellow Book of Lecan; Recension II in the Book of Leinster (c. 1160) · CELT: Rec. I 47,230 words, LL 56,150 words (verified) · good

- *What it is.* Connacht's queen Medb and her husband Ailill raid Ulster for the Brown Bull. The Ulstermen are disabled by a curse (*noínden*, the "pangs"), and the boy hero Cú Chulainn holds the ford alone, fighting single combats. Its climax is his killing of his foster-brother Fer Diad. The bull fights end in the Brown Bull shaping the land.
  - Companion tales: *Scéla Mucce Meic Dathó* (the carving of the hero's portion; savage comedy); *Longes mac nUislenn* (Deirdre); *Aided Óenfir Aífe* (Cú Chulainn kills his own son Connla); *Fled Bricrend*; *Togail Bruidne Da Derga* (the king's *gessi*, taboos, broken one by one).
  - The frame says the Táin was lost and had to be recovered by raising the dead Fergus. The LL scribe adds in Latin that he does not believe "some of these things, for some are devilish deceptions … others poetic figments". The scribes were themselves aware of the gap between oral and written.
- *Bible parallels.* Few:
  - *Aided Óenfir Aífe* + the Hildebrandslied + Rostam and Sohrab: the father who must kill his son ↔ Gen 22 and Judg 11 (typological);
  - the hero's portion ↔ 1 Sam 9:23–24;
  - single combat ↔ 1 Sam 17.
- *How old?* Jackson's "window on the Iron Age" (1964) is now largely rejected: chariots, brooches and weapons match early-medieval Ireland (Mallory, *In Search of the Irish Dreamtime*, 2016; McCone 1990, *Pagan Past and Christian Present*). Some archaic *rosc* (alliterative rhetoric) passages and the *noínden* motif look old (Watkins 1995, *How to Kill a Dragon*, for the Indo-European hero pattern).
- *Soul.* Heroic honour, boasting contests, *geis* (taboo), fosterage, the ford. High.
- *Base text and tools.* O'Rahilly, Rec. I (DIAS 1976) and LL (1967), both ©, on CELT [RESTRICTED]. PD: Windisch 1905 (LL, German); Strachan & O'Keeffe 1912 (Rec. I from YBL/LU, verify); Thurneysen's *Scéla Mucce Meic Dathó* (1935, verify ©). Translations: Kinsella 1969; Carson 2007; O'Rahilly (DIAS). **Hebrew: none found.**
- *Feasibility and risks.* Old Irish is the hardest Celtic language here for an LLM: infixed pronouns, deuterotonic/prototonic verb forms, and spelling chaos. **High risk.** eDIL is essential (down today).
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* "soul" candidate, second wave. Start with *Scéla Mucce Meic Dathó* (short, superb) and *Aided Óenfir Aífe* (for the Gen 22 dossier).

A7. Mythological Cycle: Cath Maige Tuired (The Second Battle of Mag Tuired), Tochmarc Étaíne, Aislinge Óenguso, Metrical Dindshenchas

Old/Middle Irish · CMT 9th-c. core with 11th–12th-c. additions · Harley 5280 (16th c.) · CELT: Gray edition 9,100 words, Stokes 10,127 words (both verified) · good

- *What it is.* The gods (the Tuatha Dé Danann) under the Fomorian oppressor Bres; the coming of **Lug**, master of every art (*samildánach*); Dian Cécht's healing well; the battle; Balor's evil eye; the Morrígan's prophecy of the end of the world.
  - *Tochmarc Étaíne*: rebirth through a fly swallowed in a drink.
  - *Dindshenchas* (c. 5 vols, Gwynn 1903–35): poems on the "lore of places", why each hill and river has its name.
- *Bible.*
  - The Dindshenchas is a full aetiology-of-names genre ↔ Gen 11:9, 28:19, 32:31 (aetiological naming). The comparison is typological but very useful for the commentary's "why this name" question.
  - The battle of gods ↔ *Chaoskampf* (typological).
- *Soul.* HIGH: the gods as Christian monks chose to remember them; rich social and craft detail.
- *Base text.*
  - Stokes 1891 (*Revue celtique* 12) is PD. Gray 1982 (ITS) is ©.
  - Gwynn's Dindshenchas: Gwynn died 1941, so PD in the EU (verify RIA rights). On CELT as restricted.
  - **Hebrew: none.**

- *Benefit:* Bible LOW-MED (the Dindshenchas: MEDIUM as an aetiology control) / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* CMT as a "soul" text; a Dindshenchas selection for the name-aetiology question.

A8. Early Irish law (*Senchas Már*, *Críth Gablach*, *Bretha Crólige*, *Bechbretha*, *Cáin Lánamna*, *Uraicecht Becc*; with the *Liber ex lege Moysi*)

Old Irish · tracts c. 650–750 (*Senchas Már* compiled perhaps c. 700, from three "thirds" of tracts) · mss 14th–16th c., with the archaic text broken into lemmata buried in Middle/Early Modern Irish glosses and commentary · c. 50+ tracts · text good, layout chaotic

- *What it is.* The law of a kin-based society of graded status:
  - honour-price (*lóg n-enech*, "price of the face");
  - body-price (*éraic*) for homicide, paid by the kin;
  - sick-maintenance (*othrus*) of the injured;
  - sureties (*naidm*, *ráth*, *aitire*);
  - distraint (*athgabál*) and fasting against a debtor (*troscad*, cf. Indic *dharṇa*);
  - sanctuary (*maigen* around a church or a lord's house);
  - bee law (*Bechbretha*), marriage types (*Cáin Lánamna*), kingship (*Críth Gablach*: the grades from a boy to the king, with house sizes and food rents).
- *Bible parallels.*
  - Ex 21:18–19 (the striker pays for "his loss of time" and "has him thoroughly healed") ↔ ***Bretha Crólige*** (sick-maintenance and its later commutation into payment). This is the closest legal parallel in the region.
  - Ex 21:30 *kofer* vs. Num 35:31 (no ransom for a murderer) ↔ *éraic* (ransom is the norm).
  - Ex 21:13–14 and Num 35 (refuge) ↔ *maigen*, *termonn*.
  - Ex 22:1–14 (theft, deposit, grazing) ↔ distraint and grazing trespass; Deut 24:10–13 ↔ pledges.
  - **Reception:** the *Liber ex lege Moysi* (c. 700) is an Irish excerpt-collection of Mosaic law (Ex 20–23, Lev, Num, Deut). The Hibernensis canons cite OT law constantly, and Ó Corráin, Breatnach & Breen ("The Laws of the Irish", *Peritia* 3, 1984; verify) argue that the vernacular jurists shaped native law on the OT.
  - Binchy, and Dillon (*The Archaism of Irish Tradition*, 1947), stressed the Indo-European archaism instead.
  - The **debate itself** is a model of "how much is pre-Christian?", and it bears directly on Ex 21–23.
- *Soul.* HIGH: status, honour, hospitality duties, the care of the sick, women's legal capacity, bees and dogs.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **CIH** = Binchy, *Corpus Iuris Hibernici* (DIAS 1978, 6 vols). © and diplomatic only; not online (reported).
  - **ALI** = *Ancient Laws of Ireland* (1865–1901, 6 vols). PD, but the translations are notoriously unreliable.
  - DIAS *Early Irish Law Series*, all ©: Binchy's *Críth Gablach* (1941); Kelly & Charles-Edwards, *Bechbretha* (1983); Breatnach, *Uraicecht na Ríar* (1987); Breatnach, *Córus Bésgnai* (2017).
  - Binchy, *Bretha Crólige* (*Ériu* 12, 1938, ©).
  - Kelly, *A Guide to Early Irish Law* (1988) and Breatnach, *A Companion to the CIH* (2005).
  - **Hebrew: none.**
- *Feasibility and risks.* **Very hard**: archaic legal Old Irish, terse maxims, glosses of uneven value. LLM risk **very high** without the DIAS editions at hand. The base editions are ©, so they can be used locally but not committed.
- *Benefit:* Bible MED-HIGH / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a targeted project only. Take *Bretha Crólige* and the *Liber ex lege Moysi* side by side with Ex 21–22, and the Críth Gablach status grades, working from the DIAS editions, with every reading checked against the editors' translations.

A9. Early Irish poetry: Amairgen's song, the Lament of the Old Woman of Beare, hermit and nature lyrics, gnomic texts (*Audacht Morainn*, *Tecosca Cormaic*, the Triads)

Old/Middle Irish · 7th–10th c. · various mss (marginalia in St Gall and Würzburg glosses, 9th c.) · short to medium · good

- **Amairgen's songs** (in LGE; "Am gáeth i mmuir...", "I am wind on sea..."; CELT has Gilla in Chomded's "Aimirgin Glúngel", 2,720 words). They are often taken as druidic. Carey argues for a Christian, Logos-theology reading (verify).
- **Caillech Bérri** (c. 900): an old woman laments lost youth, kings and the ebbing tide. One of the great lyrics of the Middle Ages.
- **Audacht Morainn** (c. 700; Kelly 1976, DIAS ©): "through the ruler's truth (*fír flathemon*)" the land is fruitful. Kingship and fertility ↔ Ps 72, Lev 26:3–5, Deut 28:1–12, with an Indo-European parallel (Vedic *ṛta*).
- **Trecheng Breth Féne** (the Triads of Ireland; Meyer 1906, PD) ↔ Prov 30:15–31 numerical sayings (typological).
- **Tecosca Cormaic** (Meyer 1909, PD): royal instruction ↔ Proverbs.
- Base texts: Meyer, Murphy *Early Irish Lyrics* (1956, ©); many are on CELT (restricted).
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM (Audacht and Triads) / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a short "Irish wisdom and lyric" corpus (Audacht Morainn + Triads + Caillech Bérri), in the second wave.

A10. Immram Brain, Echtrae, and Otherworld voyages

Old Irish · c. 700–750 · LU and later mss · c. 4,580 words (CELT, Mac Mathúna ed., ©)

- Bran sails to the Land of Women. Manannán, riding his chariot over the sea, sings that the sea is a flowery plain to him, and prophesies Christ. Christian reworking is overt and is part of the text's design.

- Bible: the Eden-like Otherworld ↔ Gen 2:8–14 (typological). Soul HIGH.
- *Recommendation:* a second-wave "soul" text. Its explicit Christian prophecy makes it a fine teaching case on reworking.

A11. The Four Branches of the Mabinogi (and other Middle Welsh prose)

Middle Welsh prose · c. 1060–1120 (Charles-Edwards) or later (Sims-Williams; debated) · Peniarth 6 fragments (13th c., verify date); White Book of Rhydderch (Peniarth 4–5, c. 1350); Red Book of Hergest (Jesus Coll. 111, c. 1382–1410) · c. 25,000 words (verify) · excellent

- *What it is.*
  - **Pwyll**: an exchange of shapes with the king of Annwfn; **Rhiannon** on her slow-swift horse.
  - **Branwen**: the cauldron of rebirth; Bendigeidfran's severed head, which talks for 80 years.
  - **Manawydan**: the enchanted, emptied land.
  - **Math**: Gwydion's tricks; Lleu, whom no ordinary death can kill; **Blodeuedd**, made from flowers by magicians to be Lleu's wife, who betrays him and is turned into an owl.
- *How old?* Several names are certainly pre-Christian Celtic. Rhiannon < *Rīgantonā ("great queen"); Manawydan = Irish Manannán; Lleu = Lug; Mabon = Gaulish Maponos. The tales themselves are artful 11th–12th-c. literature.
- *Bible.*
  - Blodeuedd is a woman fashioned for a man by a higher power ↔ **Gen 2:21–22**. The contrast is meaningful: Blodeuedd is made for Lleu without agency and then chooses for herself.
  - The cauldron of rebirth ↔ Ezek 37 (typological).
- *Soul.* HIGH: marriage, honour, insult and compensation (*sarhaed* ↔ the Irish honour-price), enchantment.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - Ifor Williams, *Pedeir Keinc y Mabinogi* (1930; Williams died 1965, so © to 2035).
  - PD: Rhys & Evans, *The Text of the Mabinogion … from the Red Book* (1887); Evans, *The White Book Mabinogion* (1907). Reported on archive.org.
  - The *Rhyddiaith Gymraeg 1300–1425* transcriptions (Cardiff) answered 503 today.
  - **GPC (Geiriadur Prifysgol Cymru) online is verified 200**, free.
  - Translations: Sioned Davies (OUP 2007); Ford (1977/2019).
  - **Hebrew: none found** (NLI uses the heading "מבינוגיון"; no Hebrew edition surfaced).
- *Feasibility.* Middle Welsh prose is MEDIUM risk: mutations and old spellings, but straightforward syntax.
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW-MED / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* Branch 4 (Math) first, for Blodeuedd ↔ Gen 2.

A12. Early Welsh poetry: Book of Taliesin, Y Gododdin, Canu Llywarch Hen and Canu Heledd, Trioedd Ynys Prydein, Englynion y Beddau

Early Welsh · 6th–12th c. claimed (6th-c. claims debated) · Book of Aneirin (Cardiff 2.81, c. 1250–1300); Book of Taliesin (Peniarth 2, c. 1325–50); Black Book of Carmarthen (c. 1250); Red Book · Gododdin c. 1,000+ lines; Taliesin c. 60 poems; triads c. 96 · good

- **Y Gododdin**: elegies for the warriors who "paid for their mead" at Catraeth (c. 600?). Whether its core is 6th–7th-c. is debated (Koch 1997 vs Charles-Edwards and Isaac).
- **Book of Taliesin**: *Preiddeu Annwfn* (a raid on the Otherworld for a cauldron), *Kat Godeu* (the trees go to war; "I have been in many shapes"), and biblical poems too (a poem on the plagues of Egypt, reported; verify).
- **Canu Llywarch Hen / Canu Heledd** (9th–10th c.): saga-englynion. Heledd mourns in her burnt hall: "Stafell Gynddylan ys tywyll heno" ("The hall of Cynddylan is dark tonight"). This is among the best laments in the survey (↔ 2 Sam 1, Lam 1).
- **Triads**: Bromwich, *Trioedd Ynys Prydein* (4th ed. 2014, ©). ↔ Prov 30 numerical form.
- Base texts: PD Evans facsimiles and diplomatic texts (1908, 1910); Williams, *Canu Aneirin* (1938, ©); Rowland, *Early Welsh Saga Poetry* (1990, ©); Haycock, *Legendary Poems from the Book of Taliesin* (2007/2015, ©).
- LLM risk for early Welsh poetry: **high** (obscure archaic diction).
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW (MEDIUM for the triads) / Soul HIGH (Heledd!). *Recommendation:* Canu Heledd as a "lament" text; the triads as a wisdom companion; Taliesin and Gododdin later or never.

B. GERMANIC

B1. The Poetic Edda: mythological poems (Völuspá, Hávamál, Vafþrúðnismál, Grímnismál, Hymiskviða, Þrymskviða, Lokasenna, Baldrs draumar, Rígsþula, Alvíssmál)

Old Norse (Old West Norse/Icelandic) · composition 9th–12th c. (dating is hard: Fidjestøl, *The Dating of Eddic Poetry*, 1999). Völuspá is usually placed c. 1000, around the conversion of Iceland; Hávamál is a compilation of older parts. · Codex Regius GKS 2365 4to (c. 1270); Völuspá also in Hauksbók (c. 1300–10), and stanzas quoted in Snorri · Völuspá c. 60–66 stanzas; Hávamál 164; Vafþrúðnismál 55; Grímnismál 54; Hymiskviða 39; Þrymskviða 32 · excellent

- *What it is.* A seeress tells Óðinn:
  - the world before creation (st. 3: "There was neither sand nor sea nor cool waves; earth was nowhere, nor heaven above; a yawning gap (*Ginnungagap*), and grass nowhere");
  - the sons of Burr raising the lands (st. 4), the gods setting the sun's and moon's courses and naming night, new moon, morning and evening (st. 5–6);
  - the golden age; the making of the dwarves;
  - **Askr and Embla** found on the shore, "with little power, fateless … breath (*ǫnd*) they had not, nor spirit, nor … Óðinn gave breath, Hœnir gave spirit, Lóðurr gave blood and good colour" (st. 17–18);
  - the world-ash Yggdrasill and the Norns (st. 19–20); the first war; Baldr's death;
  - Ragnarǫk: the wolf, the World Serpent (*Jǫrmungandr*) against Thor, the giant Surtr's fire;
  - and the earth rising "a second time out of the sea, evergreen" (st. 59–66).
  - **Hávamál**: rules for the guest, moderation in drink, friendship, "cattle die, kinsmen die … but fame never dies" (st. 76–77). Then Óðinn hanging on the windswept tree nine nights, "given to Óðinn, myself to myself", and winning the runes (st. 138–145).
  - **Vafþrúðnismál**: a wisdom contest to the death. Earth from Ymir's flesh, sea from his blood, sky from his skull (st. 21); Líf and Lífþrasir survive Ragnarǫk in Hoddmímir's wood (st. 45).
  - **Grímnismál**: the tortured Óðinn reveals the cosmos: the halls, Yggdrasill gnawed by serpents and a hart.
  - **Hymiskviða**: Thor hooks the World Serpent with an ox-head bait.
  - **Þrymskviða**: Thor, dressed as a bride (Freyja), recovers his hammer. It is a comic masterpiece.
- *Bible parallels* (each typological; no contact):
  - Völuspá 3 ↔ **Gen 1:2** (*tohu va-vohu* ~ *Ginnungagap*), **Gen 2:5** (*terem*… "no shrub of the field", ~ "grass nowhere"); the same formula as the Wessobrunn Prayer (B5).
  - St. 4 ↔ Gen 1:9–11 (land and green growth). St. 5–6 ↔ **Gen 1:5, 14–18**: naming the times, and the luminaries "not knowing their places".
  - **St. 17–18 ↔ Gen 2:7** (*nishmat ḥayyim*, breath given by a god to a lifeless figure). This is a famous, debated pair: some see Christian influence (e.g. McKinnell, *Both One and Many*, 1994); most see a native trio-of-gifts pattern.
  - St. 19 Yggdrasill ↔ Gen 2:9 (trees in the midst); Dan 4.
  - **Jǫrmungandr ↔ Gen 1:21 *ha-tanninim*, Job 40:25 ("canst thou draw out Leviathan with a hook?"), Isa 27:1, Ps 74:13–14.**
    - Thor fishing for the Serpent appears on the Altuna stone (Sweden) and on a stone from Gosforth church (Cumbria, 10th c.), where Christians placed it beside Christian iconography. Gregory the Great read Job 40:25 as Christ hooking Leviathan with the bait of his humanity (*Moralia in Iob* 33).
    - This "Leviathan on the hook" crossover is a real, studied reception case (verify the specific studies).
  - St. 59 ↔ **Gen 8** (earth re-emerging) and Gen 1:9. Líf and Lífþrasir ↔ Noah.
  - **Christian marks:** Hauksbók's "then the Mighty One comes to the judgement, strong, from above, who rules all" (H st. 65) is widely judged a Christian addition.
  - Hávamál ↔ Prov 23:29–35 (drink), 25:17 (don't overstay), 22:1 / Eccl 7:1 (a good name), Eccl 3. Hávamál 138 ↔ the crucifixion (Bugge 1889 argued borrowing; now mostly judged native but debated).
  - Þrymskviða ↔ Deut 22:5 (cross-dressing forbidden): a contrast, not a parallel.
  - Rígsþula: the god Ríg fathers the three estates (thrall, free farmer, earl) ↔ Gen 9:18–27, Noah's sons as the origin of estates in medieval thought. Debated; possibly Irish-influenced (*rí*, "king").
- *Soul.* HIGH: fate and the Norns; death and fame; the gods' foreknowledge of their own end; humour; wisdom for a dangerous world.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - PD: Bugge, *Sæmundar Edda* (1867), **verified at etext.old.no** (every poem listed); Finnur Jónsson's Codex Regius edition (PDF, **verified listed at septentrionalia.net**); Hauksbók facsimile edition (FJ).
  - heimskringla.no gives Guðni Jónsson's normalized text, **verified 200** (Völuspá page fetched). Licence unclear: Guðni Jónsson died 1974.
  - Current critical editions (©): Neckel–Kuhn (5th ed. 1983); Jónas Kristjánsson & Vésteinn Ólason, *Eddukvæði* (Íslenzk fornrit, 2014); Dronke, *The Poetic Edda* II (1997) and III (2011), with text, translation and commentary.
  - Menota (menota.org, **verified 200**): diplomatic XML editions of Norse manuscripts.
  - handrit.is (**verified 200**): manuscript images.
  - Dictionaries: Cleasby–Vigfusson (1874, PD; the marlluslab online version was blocked today, but PD scans exist); Zoëga 1910 (PD; Germanic Lexicon Project **verified 200**); ONP (onp.ku.dk, **verified**); La Farge & Tucker, *Glossary to the Poetic Edda* (1992, ©).
  - Free PDFs from the Viking Society (**verified listing**, http only): Evans, *Hávamál* (1986) with Faulkes' glossary.
  - Translations: Larrington (OUP rev. 2014); Crawford (2015); Dronke.
  - **Hebrew:** Tchernichovsky (Baldrs draumar, Alvíssmál; verified); Arieh Stav 2009 (most of the Edda; reported).
- *Feasibility and risks.* Old Norse is well represented in LLM training and lexica, so risk is LOW-MEDIUM. Kennings and textual cruxes in Völuspá need Dronke and Kristjánsson–Ólason at hand.
- *Benefit:* Bible **MED-HIGH** (Gen 1–2, 1:21, 8) / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation:* **translate first in this region**: Völuspá (R + H variants) with Hymiskviða, then Vafþrúðnismál, Grímnismál and Hávamál.

B2. Snorri's Prose Edda: Prologue and Gylfaginning (flag: learned systematization)

Old Norse prose with quoted verse · c. 1220–25 by Snorri Sturluson · Codex Regius of SnE (GKS 2367 4to, c. 1300–25), Uppsala, Trajectinus and Wormianus mss · c. 20k words for these parts · excellent

- The **Prologue** is a Christian euhemerist frame:
  - God creates heaven and earth and Adam and Eve; the Flood; Noah's descendants forget God;
  - the Æsir are men from Asia/Troy (Óðinn's descent from Priam).
- **Gylfaginning** systematizes the myth:
  - Ginnungagap, Niflheim and Muspell; Ymir and the cow Auðhumla;
  - the world made from Ymir's body; the first humans from two trees;
  - Thor's fishing; Baldr; Ragnarǫk.
- *Flag.* Snorri arranges, explains and sometimes invents. Many details have no older witness, e.g. Auðhumla licking Búri out of the ice. Use him as a 13th-c. Christian scholar's synthesis, never as a "pagan source".
- *Bible.*
  - Prologue = reception of Gen 1–11 (MEDIUM-HIGH as reception).
  - Gylfaginning's Ymir ↔ Tiamat in *Enūma eliš* (a creation-from-a-slain-body typology, useful for contrast with Gen 1's creation by word).
- *Base text.*
  - Faulkes, *Edda: Prologue and Gylfaginning* (Viking Society 2nd ed. 2005), a **free PDF, verified listed**, ©.
  - Finnur Jónsson's edition, PD, verified at Septentrionalia.
  - **Hebrew: none found.**
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul MED-HIGH. *Recommendation:* translate the Prologue (short) for the Gen 10–11 dossier. Use Gylfaginning only for notes.

B3. Skaldic mythological poems (Bragi's Ragnarsdrápa, Þjóðólfr's Haustlǫng, Úlfr Uggason's Húsdrápa, Eilífr's Þórsdrápa)

Old Norse skaldic verse · 9th–10th c., securely datable through named poets and patrons; the oldest dated Norse myth · preserved as quotations in Snorri's Skáldskaparmál (13th–14th-c. mss) · c. 150 stanzas · fair (fragmentary, reassembled by editors)

- Ragnarsdrápa (Bragi, 9th c.?) includes Thor's fishing for the Serpent.
- Húsdrápa (c. 985) describes carvings in a hall at Hjarðarholt: Thor's fishing, Baldr's funeral.
- **Bible:** Leviathan on the hook (Job 40:25; Gen 1:21). These are pre-conversion witnesses that the motif is native, which matters for item B1.
- Base texts:
  - Finnur Jónsson, *Den norsk-islandske skjaldedigtning* A1–B2 (1912–15), PD, **verified listed at Septentrionalia**.
  - The Skaldic Project (SkP, Brepols, ©). skaldic.org **blocks scripts** (a "Checking your browser" page; www gives a TLS error).
- LLM risk: MEDIUM-HIGH (kennings, word order).
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* include the Thor-fishing stanzas in the Edda project's apparatus.

B4. Runic inscriptions: Rök, Eggja, Gallehus, Björketorp, Viking-age runestones

Proto-Norse (c. 200–700) and Old Norse (700–1100) · the originals themselves · Elder Futhark c. 350–400 inscriptions, mostly very short; Rök (Östergötland, c. 800) c. 760 runes, the longest; Eggja (Norway, c. 650–700) c. 200 runes, a grave-slab; Viking-age stones c. 3,000 in Sweden · fair to good

- **Gallehus horn** (c. 400): "ek hlewagastiz holtijaz horna tawido", "I, Hlewagastiz son of Holt, made the horn". The oldest Germanic alliterative line.
- **Björketorp** curse (7th c.): "I foretell destruction" against whoever breaks the monument.
- **Rök** (c. 800): a father's memorial for his son Vämoð, with riddling stanzas and cipher runes.
  - Holmberg, Gräslund, Sundqvist & Williams (2020, *Futhark* 9–10) read nine riddles, five answered "the sun", as anxiety about another "Fimbulwinter" like the 536–550 cold. Reported; the authors' proposal, contested.
  - One stanza is in eddic metre and mentions Theodoric.
- Viking-age stones are often Christian ("God help his soul").
- Bible: weak (the father's memorial ↔ 2 Sam 18:18 Absalom's pillar, typological).
- Base data:
  - **Rundata**, Samnordisk runtextdatabas: ODbL + DbCL (reported, Uppsala). runforum.nordiska.uu.se **reset today**.
  - **Runor** (app.raa.se/open/runor, Swedish National Heritage Board) **verified 200**; it is a JavaScript application.
- LLM risk: MEDIUM (runological cruxes).
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW / Soul MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* a short "voices in stone" selection (Rök, Eggja, Björketorp, Gallehus) as an appendix to the Edda project.

B5. Old High German: Wessobrunn Prayer, Merseburg Charms, Muspilli, Hildebrandslied

OHG (Bavarian, East Franconian, Old Saxon-tinged) · mss c. 814 (Wessobrunn, Clm 22053), c. 830–40 (Hildebrandslied, Kassel), c. 870 (Muspilli, Clm 14098), 10th c. (Merseburg, Domstiftsbibliothek 136) · Wessobrunn 9 verse lines + prose prayer; Merseburg 2 charms of c. 4–5 lines each; Hildebrandslied 68 lines; Muspilli c. 103 lines · Hildebrandslied breaks off; the others are complete

- **Wessobrunn Prayer** (verified on de.wikisource: "Dat gafregin ih mit firahim firiuuizzo meista, dat ero ni uuas noh ufhimil, noh paum noh pereg ni uuas …").
  - Translation: "This I learned among men as the greatest of wonders: that there was no earth nor heaven above, nor tree nor mountain, nor sun shone nor moon gave light, nor the glorious sea. When there was nothing of ends or limits, there was the one almighty God …"
  - The negative opening *ero … ufhimil* is word for word the Norse *jǫrð … upphiminn* of Völuspá 3, so it is an inherited Germanic, and ultimately Indo-European, formula: the Rigveda's "there was neither the non-existent nor the existent" (RV 10.129).
  - A Christian poet poured it into a creation prayer.
  - ↔ **Gen 2:4b–5** ("no shrub of the field was yet …") and **Gen 1:1–2**; also *Enūma eliš* I 1–8 ("when on high heaven was not named …") and Prov 8:24–26 ("when there were no depths …").
  - Consensus: the formula's inheritance is accepted. Its Genesis connection is reception by the Christian author.
- **Merseburg Charms.** I: the *Idisi* (divine women) loose fetters. II: Phol and Wodan ride; Balder's (?) foal sprains its foot; goddesses sing over it, then Wodan: "bone to bone, blood to blood, limb to limbs, as if they were glued". Pre-Christian gods named in a 10th-c. clerical manuscript.
  - The formula matches Atharvaveda 4.12, an accepted Indo-European inheritance (Kuhn 1864; Watkins 1995).
  - ↔ **Ezek 37:7** "bone to its bone" (typological, striking).
- **Muspilli**: Elijah fights Antichrist; the world burns; the Last Judgement. *mūspilli* is cognate with Norse Múspell (Ragnarǫk's fire). A Christian apocalypse in pagan vocabulary; the reception case in reverse.
- **Hildebrandslied**: the father, returning after 30 years, must fight his son, who does not believe him. It breaks off before the outcome. ↔ Gen 22 (typological); the Irish *Aided Óenfir Aífe* (A6) and the Persian *Shahnameh*'s Rostam and Sohrab form the Indo-European "father–son combat" dossier.
- Base texts: PD; de.wikisource (Wessobrunn verified; Merseburg returned 429 rate-limit, retry); Braune, *Althochdeutsches Lesebuch* (old editions PD); Titus (titus.fkidg1.uni-frankfurt.de mirror **verified 200**; the main host reset); BSB digitized Clm 22053 (digitale-sammlungen.de **verified 200**).
- Tools: Köbler, *Althochdeutsches Wörterbuch* (online, reported); Schützeichel.
- LLM risk: LOW-MEDIUM.
- **Hebrew: none known.**
- *Benefit:* Bible **HIGH** (Wessobrunn ↔ Gen 1:1–2, 2:5; short) / Soul MED-HIGH. *Recommendation:* **translate early**, as the core of the "when there was not" dossier (shortlist #3). It is a few hours' work with an outsized payoff for Gen 1:2.

B6. Beowulf (with Widsith, Deor, Maxims I–II, Cædmon's Hymn)

Old English · Beowulf: 8th c. (Fulk 1992, Kaluza's law; Neidorf ed. 2014) to c. 1000 (debated); the single ms is Cotton Vitellius A.xv (c. 1000), fire-damaged 1731 · 3,182 lines · Widsith 143, Deor 42, Maxims I c. 206 and II 66 (Exeter Book c. 970 and Cotton Tiberius B.i); Cædmon's Hymn 9 lines (Bede *HE* IV.24; the Moore Bede c. 737) · good

- *What it is.* The Danish king's hall Heorot is attacked by Grendel. Beowulf kills him and his mother; fifty years later he dies killing a dragon.
  - At Heorot's founding the poet sings creation: "how the Almighty made the earth, the bright plain that water encircles; set, triumphant, sun and moon as lights for land-dwellers" (90–98) ↔ **Gen 1:1–18**.
  - Grendel is "of Cain's kin, … the eternal Lord avenged the killing, that he slew Abel … from him all misbegotten creatures woke, giants and elves and orcs, likewise the giants who strove against God for a long time; He gave them their reward" (104–114) ↔ **Gen 4:8–16, 6:4**.
  - The giant-sword hilt shows "the origin of ancient strife, when the flood, the rushing ocean, slew the race of giants" (1688–1693) ↔ **Gen 6–7**.
- *How much is pre-Christian?* The legend world is Germanic: Scyld, Hrothgar, Ingeld, Sigemund the dragon-slayer, the Geats; Widsith and Deor show the same world. The poet, though, is a Christian looking back on pagans (Tolkien 1936).
- *Bible.* Direct reception of **Gen 4 and 6** (Mellinkoff, "Cain's Monstrous Progeny in Beowulf", *ASE* 8–9, 1979–80; Orchard, *Pride and Prodigies*, 1995). It shows how an early-medieval poet fused Gen 6:1–4 with northern monsters, which bears directly on the commentary's Gen 6:4 and the *nefilim*.
  - Cædmon's Hymn is the moment Germanic oral formulas first turned to Genesis: "Now we must praise heaven-kingdom's Guardian … He first created for the children of men heaven as a roof".
  - Maxims ↔ Proverbs ("Frost shall freeze, fire melt wood …").
- *Soul.* HIGH: the hall-joy and its loss; lament (the "Lay of the Last Survivor", 2247–66); the Geatish woman's lament at the pyre; fate (*wyrd*).
- *Base text and tools.*
  - PD older editions: Wyatt–Chambers 1914; Klaeber 1922 (PD in the US; verify the EU position).
  - **Electronic Beowulf 5th ed. (ebeowulf.uky.edu), verified 200**: free, © Kiernan; edition, manuscript images, glossary.
  - Klaeber 4 (2008, ©); Fulk, *Beowulf and the Fight at Finnsburh* (DOML 2010, ©).
  - **Bosworth–Toller online, verified 200**. The DOE is behind a Cloudflare check.
  - ASPR for the minor poems (1931–53; status varies; verify).
  - Translations: Heaney; Fulk; Liuzza.
  - **Hebrew:** Arieh Stav (reported online PDF; publication details to verify).
- *Feasibility.* Old English is well-resourced; LLM risk LOW-MEDIUM.
- *Benefit:* Bible **MED-HIGH** (Gen 4, 6) / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* translate. Start with the Cain and Flood passages and the creation song (≈ 120 lines) for the Gen 4–6 commentary, then the whole poem.

B7. Old English metrical charms: Æcerbot, Nine Herbs Charm, Wið færstice, and others

OE · pre-Christian core in a Christian frame · BL Cotton Caligula A.vii (Æcerbot, 11th c.), Harley 585 (Lacnunga, c. 1000) · c. 12 metrical charms, c. 250 lines · good

- **Æcerbot** (field remedy, c. 86 lines):
  - sods are cut, sprinkled with holy water and milk and taken to church for four masses;
  - the plough is anointed while the farmer chants "Erce, Erce, Erce, eorþan modor" ("Erce, mother of earth") and "Hal wes þu, folde, fira modor" ("Hail, earth, mother of men");
  - a loaf is laid under the first furrow.
  - It is the most vivid documented fusion of an agrarian earth-cult with Christian liturgy.
  - ↔ Gen 3:17–19 (the cursed ground; the charm re-blesses it), Gen 4:2–3, Deut 28:4–5, Lev 23:10 (first-fruits; typological).
- **Nine Herbs Charm**: "Woden took nine glory-twigs, smote the adder so that it flew into nine parts" ↔ Gen 3:15 (typological); then "Christ stood over disease".
- **Wið færstice** ("against a sudden stitch"): the *ese* (gods), elves and hags shoot spears; the healer shoots back.
- Base texts: ASPR 6 (Dobbie 1942; verify status); Storms, *Anglo-Saxon Magic* (1948); Pettit, *Anglo-Saxon Remedies, Charms and Prayers from BL MS Harley 585* (2001, ©).
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a small corpus, the "charm" counterpart to the Mesopotamian incantations. Easy.

B8. Gothic (Wulfila), Old Saxon, Old English biblical poetry: out of scope, but mention

- **Wulfila's Gothic Bible** (4th c.; Codex Argenteus, 6th c.) is a Bible translation and out of scope (wulfila.be **verified 200**). The *Skeireins* is a commentary on John.
- **Old Saxon Heliand** (c. 830) and the **Genesis fragments**; **OE Genesis A/B** (Junius 11, c. 1000, 2,936 lines; Genesis B translated from Old Saxon, with Satan's fall and the temptation): these are biblical paraphrases.
  - They are a rich *reception* resource for Gen 1–22: the fallen angels, and Eve deceived by a demon disguised as an angel. They are not "ancient texts", but worth a row in a future "reception" list.
- Tacitus, *Germania* 2 (98 CE; Latin, a classical witness): the Germans sing in "ancient songs" of **Tuisto, born from the earth, and his son Mannus**, father of the three tribal groups. ↔ Gen 2:7 (*adam* from *adamah*) and the threefold division of Gen 9:19 / 10. A neat external control. Latin probably belongs to the Classical survey.

C. BALTIC

C1. Latvian dainas (*Latvju dainas*)

Latvian (incl. Latgalian) · quatrain song-tradition; recorded 1770–1903; many mythic motifs certainly Indo-European · Barons & Wissendorff, *Latvju dainas* (6 vols in 8, 1894–1915) · c. 218,000 texts incl. variants (reported; the type-numbering is around 36,000) · excellent

- *What it is.* Short four-line trochaic songs for every stage of life: birth, orphanhood, courtship, the wedding, work, death.
  - The **mythological dainas**: **Saule** the sun-mother driving her chariot and sinking into the sea; the **Saules meita** (sun's daughter) and her wooing by the **Dieva dēli** (sons of God) or by Mēness (the moon), whom the thunder-god Pērkons cleaves for his betrayal; **Dievs** the sky-god riding down the hill, dressed as a farmer, to bless the fields; **Laima**, the fate-goddess at birth; **Māra**; **Veļi** (the dead).
- *How old?* The *Dieva dēli* courting the sun's daughter match the Vedic Aśvins and Sūryā and the Greek Dioskouroi with Helen (Ward 1968, *The Divine Twins*; West, *Indo-European Poetry and Myth*, 2007). This is the strongest comparative proof that a 19th-c. oral corpus preserves an Indo-European sun-myth.
  - Counter-pressures: Lutheran and Catholic Christianity; Romantic-nationalist selection by collectors; Barons' editorial choices (he left out "indecent" songs into a separate vol., *Nerātnās dziesmas*).
- *Bible.*
  - Gen 1:14–18: Genesis' lights are *unnamed* and functional, while the dainas' sun and moon are persons who marry, quarrel and weep. A clean contrast that illuminates the deliberate demythologizing of Gen 1:16 (typological).
  - Orphan laments ↔ Ex 22:21–23 (the widow and the orphan), Deut 10:18.
- *Soul.* **HIGH**: the most intimate peasant voice in Europe; work, orphanhood, the sun as mother.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - LD 1894–1915: Barons died 1923, Wissendorff 1909, so PD (reported scans; the Latvian National Digital Library).
  - **dainuskapis.lv** (Cabinet of Folksongs, digital): **Cloudflare "you have been blocked" (403) today.**
  - **korpuss.lv "Latvju dainas" corpus, verified**: vol. 2 of LD, 46,576 songs, 680k words, revised 2019–25; no licence shown.
  - garamantas.lv (Archives of Latvian Folklore): 403.
  - Tools: Mīlenbahs–Endzelīns, *Latviešu valodas vārdnīca* (1923–32, PD; online at tezaurs.lv, reported).
  - Translations: Vīķis-Freibergs (ed.), *Linguistic and Poetic Aspects of Latvian Dainas*; various anthologies.
  - **Hebrew: none found.**
- *Feasibility.* MEDIUM: modern Latvian is decently handled; LD uses old orthography and dialect forms. The quatrains are short, so errors stay visible.
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW-MED / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* a curated selection of c. 300 mythological, orphan and death dainas. Wait until dainuskapis.lv is reachable, or use LD scans.

C2. Lithuanian *dainos*, *raudos* (laments) and *sutartinės*; Old Prussian

Lithuanian · recorded from the 17th c. (Daukša, 1595 preface) but mostly 19th–20th c. · *Lietuvių liaudies dainynas* (LLTI, 1980–; 25+ vols, ©) · many thousands · good

- **Raudos**: women's laments for the dead, improvised in a fixed idiom ("my little mother, where shall I seek you …") ↔ Jer 9:16–20 (*meqonenot*), 2 Sam 1:17–27, Lam (typological).
- **Sutartinės**: polyphonic songs (UNESCO).
- Mythology is mostly second-hand (Łasicki's *De diis Samagitarum*, c. 1580, Latin; the 1261 Malalas gloss).
- **Old Prussian**: the Basel epigram (1369, 2 lines); the catechisms (1545, 1561) are Christian translations. Simon Grunau's pantheon (Patollo, Perkuno, Potrimpo, 16th c.) is unreliable.
- Access: llti.lt reset; www.llti.lt 200; lfk.lt blocked; tautosakos-rankrastynas.lt 200 (reported content).
- LLM: MEDIUM. **Hebrew: none.**
- *Benefit:* Bible LOW-MED / Soul MED-HIGH. *Recommendation:* consider a small laments selection alongside the Russian laments (D1) and Canu Heledd (A12).

D. SLAVIC

D1. Russian byliny, the Dove Book (*Golubinaya kniga*) and the North-Russian laments

Russian folk epic and spiritual verse · Kievan setting (Vladimir, 10th–11th c.); the form crystallized perhaps 14th–17th c. (debated) · Kirsha Danilov's collection (ms c. 1740s–60s, publ. 1804/1818); Rybnikov (1861–67); Hilferding (1873); Bessonov, *Kaleki perekhozhie* (1861–64, spiritual verse); Barsov, *Prichitaniya Severnogo kraya* (1872–86, the laments of Irina Fedosova) · thousands of texts · good

- **Byliny**:
  - Ilya Muromets; **Dobrynya and the Serpent** (Zmei Gorynych): a dragon-fight ↔ Ps 74:13 / Isa 27:1 (typological);
  - **Svyatogor**, the giant the earth cannot bear, who lies down in a stone coffin and cannot rise ↔ Gen 6:4 *nefilim* (typological);
  - Volkh Vseslavyevich the shape-shifter; Sadko in the Sea King's palace; Mikula the ploughman.
- **The Dove Book** (spiritual verse, recorded 17th–19th c.):
  - "From what did the white world begin?";
  - the sun from God's face, the moon from his breast, the dawn from his eyes;
  - man from eight parts (body from earth, bones from stone, blood from the sea, thoughts from the clouds) — the "Adam octipartite" of **2 Enoch 30:8**, via Slavonic apocrypha;
  - the "mother of all fish", the **whale on which the earth rests ↔ Gen 1:21** and Leviathan.
  - This is a direct Christian-apocryphal reception of Gen 1–2, fused with folk cosmology (and possibly the Indo-European cosmic body, Purusha/Ymir).
- **Fedosova's laments** (19th c., c. 30,000 lines from one woman): the soul of mourning.
- *Bible.* Dove Book MED-HIGH (reception of Gen 1–2; 1:21); byliny LOW-MED.
- *Base text.* PD 19th-c. editions; FEB "Былины и песни" (feb-web.ru) **verified 200**; Russian Wikisource **verified 200**. The modern *Svod russkogo fol'klora: Byliny* (2001–) is ©.
- LLM: Russian strong. Archaic and dialect vocabulary at MEDIUM risk.
- **Hebrew:** none known for the byliny. Stav's *Lay of Igor* is a literary text, not a bylina.
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* the Dove Book (2–3 variants, c. 200–300 lines) for the Gen 1:21 and 2:7 apparatus; byliny and laments as "soul" texts later.

D2. Primary Chronicle (*Povest' vremennykh let*), opening: the Table of Nations

Old East Slavic · c. 1113 (Nestor tradition) · Laurentian Codex (1377), Hypatian (c. 1425) · opening c. 2,000 words · excellent

- After the Flood the sons of Noah divide the earth; Japheth's lot includes the north and west; the 72 nations at the Tower; "the Slavs from the tribe of Japheth" (the Noricans), then the Slavic peoples.
- **Gen 10–11 reception, HIGH** (part of dossier E1).
- PD base: PSRL I (1926–28; reported). LLM: MED-GOOD.
- *Recommendation:* include in E1.

D3. Other Slavic material

- **South Slavic epic** (Vuk Karadžić 1814–62; the Parry–Lord collection): Ottoman-era heroic song. Its value is for oral-formulaic theory, not antiquity. Stav's Kosovo selection in Hebrew is reported.
- **The Lay of Igor's Campaign** (*Slovo o polku Igoreve*, 12th c.?): a literary text whose only manuscript burned in 1812. Authenticity long debated; now mostly accepted after Zaliznyak (2004). The pagan gods Dazhbog, Stribog and Veles are mentioned in passing. Bible LOW; Soul MEDIUM.
- **Slavic pagan sources** are all second-hand: the Primary Chronicle's Perun idol (980), Thietmar, Helmold, Saxo on Svantevit.

E. CROSS-REGIONAL RECEPTION DOSSIER

E1. "The Table of Nations in the North and the Caucasus": medieval peoples writing themselves into Gen 10–11

Middle Irish, Old East Slavic, Classical Armenian, Old Georgian, Old Norse (+ Latin: *Historia Brittonum* §§10–18; the Frankish Table of Nations / *Generatio regum et gentium*, c. 520) · 6th–13th c.

- **Lebor Gabála** (A4): Magog son of Japheth, Fénius at the Tower, the Flood survivor Fintan.
- **Auraicept** (A5): the 72 languages; Irish distilled from them.
- **Primary Chronicle** (D2): the Slavs from Japheth.
- **Movses Khorenatsi, *History of the Armenians* I.5–12** (Classical Armenian; claimed 5th c., probably 8th c.; Thomson 1978/2006):
  - **Hayk**, descendant of Japheth through **Torgom** (Togarmah, Gen 10:3; cf. Ezek 27:14 "Beth Togarmah"), rebels against the tyrant **Bel** (identified with Nimrod, Gen 10:8–12) after the Tower;
  - Hayk withdraws to Ararat, then kills Bel with an arrow.
  - This is the Armenian national origin as an anti-Babel story.
- **Leonti Mroveli** (*Kartlis tskhovreba*, 11th c., Old Georgian): **Targamos** (Togarmah), son of Tarshish son of Japheth, and his eight sons (Haos, Kartlos, Bardos, Movakan, Lekan, Heros, Kavkas, Egros) as eponyms of the Caucasian peoples.
- **Snorri's Prologue** (B2).
- *Bible.* **HIGH** as reception for Gen 10:2–5 (Japheth), 10:3 (Togarmah), 10:8–12 (Nimrod), 11:1–9 (Babel), 8:4 (Ararat). It shows which features of the Table medieval readers treated as productive: eponyms, the 72, the Tower as the origin of languages, Nimrod as tyrant. Ancient Jewish reception (Jubilees 8–10, Josephus *Ant.* I.120–147) supplies the bridge.
- *Soul.* MEDIUM (identity and belonging).
- *Feasibility.* MEDIUM. Each excerpt is short, but in a different language. Classical Armenian and Old East Slavic are reasonably handled by an LLM; Middle Irish less so. Base texts: Macalister (LGE), Calder (Auraicept, PD), PSRL (PD), Abeghyan–Yarutiwnean's Armenian text (1913, PD?, verify), Qauxchishvili's Georgian (1955, ©).
- *Recommendation:* **a high-value, moderate-cost project for the empty Gen 8:20–11:26 block.** Coordinate with the Near-East/Caucasus-Armenian survey if another region covers Movses.

F. FINNIC AND SÁMI

F1. Finnic "old runes": SKVR (*Suomen Kansan Vanhat Runot*)

Finnish, Karelian, Ingrian (Izhorian), Votic · trochaic tetrameter "Kalevala meter", with alliteration and parallelism. Its age is estimated linguistically and comparatively at least 1st millennium CE, perhaps older (Kuusi; Siikala, *Mythic Images and Shamanism*, 2002; Frog; Kallio). It is debated and cannot be dated per poem. · recorded 1564–1939 (verified README); main collecting 1820s–1930s by Lönnrot, Europaeus, Krohn, Borenius and others · 89,247 texts (verified) · excellent (notated by trained collectors; the dialect orthography varies)

- *What it is.*
  - **Maailman synty** (Creation of the World): a bird (a duck, swallow or eagle) looks for a place to nest on the primeval sea, finds Väinämöinen's knee and lays eggs. They roll and break: "the lower half became the earth below, the upper half the heaven above, the yolk the sun, the white the moon, the speckles stars".
  - **Iso tammi** (the Great Oak), which blots out sun and moon until a tiny man from the sea fells it.
  - **The Sampo**, forged and stolen. Väinämöinen's journey to Tuonela (the land of the dead) and to the dead giant Antero Vipunen for words of power.
  - Lemminkäinen's death and his mother's raking of the river.
  - **Synnyt** (origin-incantations): *Raudan synty* (the origin of iron from the milk of three maidens), the origin of fire, of the snake, of the bear. To cure an injury, the healer must recite its origin. A theology of naming and knowing.
  - Also **Christian legend-songs** in the same meter (Mary/Marjatta, Christ's harrowing of hell, St Stephen). They show the reworking in action, and the collectors' metadata identify the Orthodox Karelian and Lutheran Finnish contexts.
- *How old and how do we know?*
  - Shared motifs across Finnish, Karelian and Estonian (the bird and egg; the Great Oak) imply a Proto-Finnic layer.
  - Old loanwords and archaic grammar sit in the meter.
  - Agricola's list of Karelian and Tavastian gods (1551) proves a pagan pantheon.
  - Wide Eurasian parallels of the bird-and-egg cosmogony (the earth-diver; the world-egg).
  - Single texts are 19th-c. performances and must be presented as such.

- *Bible.*
  - **Gen 1:2** *ve-ruaḥ elohim meraḥefet ʿal-penei ha-mayim*: the bird hovering over the primeval waters looking for a nest. Rashi glosses *meraḥefet* "like a dove hovering over its nest"; cf. Deut 32:11 (the eagle *yeraḥef* over its young).
  - **Gen 1:6–8, 14–16**: the egg divided into heaven above and earth below, with the luminaries from the yolk and white; the Genesis *raqiaʿ* divides waters.
  - Typological (no contact), but the Finnic material gives a vivid, well-documented "bird over the deep" cosmogony against which the restraint of Gen 1:2 stands out.
  - Synnyt ↔ Gen 2:19–20 (naming gives knowledge and power).
  - The Great Oak ↔ Dan 4 and Ezek 31 (the world-tree felled).
  - Typological, with **strong motif-level value**.
- *Soul.* **HIGH**: the singer-healer's world, the sauna and the bear-feast, women's laments (Ingrian *itkuvirret*), the shaman's journey to the dead.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - **SKVR, open data, CC BY 4.0**, verified: the GitHub sks190/SKVR README via raw.githubusercontent.com.
  - The **zip of 89,247 TEI files** (aineistot.finlit.fi/exist/rest/db/apps/skvr/data/SKVR.zip, 128.5 MB, verified header and central directory) contains `TEI/skvrVVNNNNNN.xml` plus `collectors.csv`, `places.csv` and a taxonomy.
  - The web edition (aineistot.finlit.fi/exist/apps/skvr/, TEI Publisher) is **verified 200**. skvr.fi redirects there.
  - The README asks for sensitivity: Karelian, Ingrian and Votic communities may object to some uses.
  - **JR** (unpublished supplement) is not yet open. The combined Finnic database (SKVR + Estonian ERAB, "FILTER", c. 280,000 texts) is reported.
  - Tools: Finnish dictionaries are excellent. The Karelian dictionary (*Karjalan kielen sanakirja*) and *Suomen murteiden sanakirja* are online at kaino.kotus.fi (403 today). Kuusi, Bosley & Branch, *Finnish Folk Poetry: Epic* (1977, bilingual, ©), is the best English check.
  - **Hebrew:** Tchernichovsky's Kalevala selections (1930, via German; verified bibliography) are the **composed Kalevala**, not SKVR. Use them only for register, consulted after drafting.
- *Feasibility.* HIGH. Finnish is well-resourced. Karelian dialect texts (e.g. Viena Karelian, the heartland of the epic) are MEDIUM risk. Parallelism helps: every line is restated in the next.
- *Benefit:* Bible MED-HIGH / Soul **HIGH**. *Recommendation:* **top candidate.** Translate the Creation of the World in 4–6 key variants (Viena Karelia, Ingria), the Great Oak, the Origin of Iron and the Sampo, with the collectors' metadata and a variant apparatus.

F2. Estonian *regilaul* (runosongs)

Estonian incl. Seto and South Estonian dialects · same Finnic meter · recorded 19th–20th c. (Hurt, Eisen) · 92,134 regilaul texts in the Estonian database (reported) · good

- **Loomislaul** (the Creation song): a bird builds a nest and lays eggs, from which sun, moon and stars come. **Suur tamm** (the Great Oak). Women's songs predominate.
- Access: folklore.ee (ERAB regilaul database) **reset today**; regilaul.ee and erlas.folklore.ee blocked; licence not found.
- Base texts: the "Vana Kannel" series (1875–, ©/PD mixed).
- LLM: MEDIUM-LOW (dialects).
- **Hebrew: none.**
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* compare variants in the SKVR project's apparatus when the host is reachable.

F3. Sámi: yoik, myths, and missionary reports

Sámi languages · oldest texts: two yoiks by Olaus Sirma in Schefferus' *Lapponia* (1673; Sámi + Latin, PD) · myths collected 18th–20th c. (Qvigstad, *Lappiske eventyr og sagn*, 1927–29) · plus Lutheran missionary accounts (Isaac Olsen c. 1715, Jens Kildal), hostile and second-hand

- Anders Fjellner's "Son of the Sun" (*Beaivi bártni*, 19th c.) is a Romantic reworking. Flag it.
- Laestadius, *Fragments of Lappish Mythology* (1840s; English 2002).
- Bible: Sámi flood tales ↔ Gen 6–9 (typological; possibly missionary-influenced).
- LLM: **LOW**. Access: giellatekno.uit.no **verified 200** (Sámi language tools); saami.uit.no blocked.
- **Hebrew: none.**
- *Benefit:* LOW-MED / MEDIUM. *Recommendation:* Sirma's two 1673 yoiks as a curiosity, no more.

G. BASQUE

No ancient texts.

- Aquitanian (1st–3rd c. CE) survives only as personal names and theonyms in Latin inscriptions (Gorrochategui 1984).
- The first Basque words are in the Emilian Glosses (10th–11th c.); the first book is Etxepare (1545).
- Late-medieval ballads (Bereterretxe; Beotibar) are fragmentary.
- **Forgeries:** the *Altabiskarko kantua* (1830s, the "Song of Altabiskar" on Roncevaux); the Iruña-Veleia "graffiti" (2006, ruled forged by a court in 2020); the *Leloaren kantua* is suspect.
- *Recommendation:* exclude.

H. CAUCASUS

H1. Ossetian Nart sagas (*Narty kaddžytæ*)

Ossetian (Iron, Digor; Iranian, descendant of Alanic and Scythian) · roots claimed in Scythian–Sarmatian culture (Dumézil, *Légendes sur les Nartes*, 1930; *Le livre des héros*, 1965; Abaev) · first records 1840s (Sjögren), then Vs. Miller, *Osetinskie etyudy* (1881–87, Ossetian texts with Russian translation, PD); *Pamyatniki narodnogo tvorchestva osetin* (1925–27); *Narty kaddžytæ* (Dzaudžyqæu 1946); academic *Nartæ* (1989–91, reported) · c. 90–200 tales by edition · good

- *What it is.*
  - The Narts are a race of heroes in three families: the strong (Æxsærtæggatæ), the rich (Boratæ) and the wise (Alægatæ).
  - **Satana**, the all-wise matriarch. **Soslan/Sozyryko**, born from a stone impregnated by a shepherd and tempered in wolf's milk, with one vulnerable spot. **Batradz**, of steel, dies only when the Narts throw his sword into the sea.
  - The Narts' **end**: they grow so proud they challenge God (Xucau). Offered a choice between a long line of descendants or eternal fame, they **choose fame**, and perish.
- *How old?* Herodotus 4.5–10 (the Scythian origins: golden plough, yoke, axe and cup fall from heaven; the three sons) and Dumézil's trifunctional analysis tie Ossetian lore to the Scythians. Plausible, but thematic, not textual.
  - The Batradz–Excalibur link (Littleton & Malcor, *From Scythia to Camelot*, 1994) is speculative and widely rejected.
  - Christian layering is clear: **Uastyrdži** (= St George) and **Uacilla** (= St Elijah, lord of thunder and harvest) are saints who took over divine functions.
- *Bible.*
  - The Narts' choice of "name" over life ↔ **Gen 6:4** (*anshei ha-shem*, "men of renown") and **Gen 11:4** (*ve-naʿaseh lanu shem*, "let us make us a name"). A typological control for the "name" motif in the commentary's empty block, MEDIUM.
  - Stone-birth ↔ Deut 32:18 ("the Rock that begot thee"), typological.
- *Soul.* HIGH: feasting, women's power, the ethic of fame.
- *Base text and tools.*
  - Miller 1881–87 (PD, reported). The Soviet-era Ossetian editions are © and **not found online** (search only).
  - ironau.ru (Ossetian portal with dictionaries and grammar) **verified 200**, cp1251 encoding. The Ossetic national corpus (corpus.ossetic-studies.org) reset.
  - English: Colarusso & Salbiev (eds.), May (tr.), *Tales of the Narts* (Princeton 2016), **from Russian**, not Ossetian.
  - **Hebrew: none.**
- *Feasibility.* LOW. LLM competence in Ossetian is limited, and the base texts are hard to obtain. Translating from Russian would break the rule of working from the original.
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* defer. Revisit if an open Ossetian text, e.g. Miller's PD volumes, can be fetched and checked.

H2. Circassian (Adyghe/Kabardian) and Abkhaz Nart sagas

Northwest Caucasian languages · recorded 19th–20th c. · *Nartkher* (*Нартхэр*), 7 vols, Maikop 1968–71 (©); English: Colarusso, *Nart Sagas from the Caucasus* (Princeton 2002; repr. 2016, ©)

- Sosruquo born from a stone; Tlepsh the smith-god; Satanay; the giant Yemine. Abkhaz: Sasrïqwa and the 99 brothers; Abrskil (a Prometheus-like rebel chained in a cave).
- LLM: **very low** (some of the world's most complex phonologies and morphologies).
- *Benefit:* LOW-MED / HIGH. *Recommendation:* exclude as a translation project; cite in the Ossetian and Amirani apparatus.

H3. Georgian Amirani

Georgian (folk, many dialects) · a pre-Greek Caucasian core is argued (Charachidzé, *Prométhée ou le Caucase*, 1986) · records from the 19th c.; the academic collection *Amiranis eposi* (Chikovani 1947, ©, verify); medieval reflexes in Mose Khoneli's prose romance *Amiran-Darejaniani* (12th c.) · dozens of variants · good

- Amirani, a giant-killing hero born of a goddess, challenges God (or Christ) to a contest and is chained to a mountain in the Caucasus. His dog licks the chain thin every year, but on Maundy Thursday the smiths strike their anvils to make it whole again. Aeschylus' Prometheus is also bound in the Caucasus.
- *Bible.* The bound rebel ↔ Gen 6:1–4 via **1 Enoch 10:4–6** (Asael bound under rocks until judgement) and Isa 14:12–15. Typological, MEDIUM.
- The Armenian **Artavazd** (Movses II.61: chained in a cave in **Masis = Ararat**; dogs gnaw his chains; smiths strike anvils on Sundays) is the same motif in a 5th–8th-c. text. The pairing is strong and **datable**, and connects with Gen 8:4.
- LLM: Georgian MEDIUM (folk dialect lower). Base editions are Soviet-©, not online (reported).
- **Hebrew: none.**
- *Benefit:* Bible MEDIUM / Soul MED-HIGH. *Recommendation:* translate Movses' Artavazd passage in E1/H4; Amirani in summary in the notes.

H4. Armenian: Movses Khorenatsi's pagan song-fragments and the epic *Sasna Tsrer* (Daredevils of Sasun / David of Sasun)

(a) Classical Armenian, in Movses Khorenatsi (claimed 5th c., probably 8th c.) · fragments of the "songs of Gołtʻn" sung by minstrels: c. 30 lines in all · (b) the epic in the Mush/Sasun dialects of Western Armenian, recorded from 1873 (Srvandztiants, from Krpo of Mush); c. 160 variants; compiled text 1939 (Abeghyan et al.); academic multi-volume variant edition from 1936 (reported); UNESCO

2012 · good

- (a) **The Birth of Vahagn** (Movses I.31). "Heaven was in travail, earth was in travail, the purple sea was in travail; in the sea the red reed was in travail; from the reed's stem smoke rose, from the reed's stem flame rose, and from the flame a youth ran out: he had hair of fire, a beard of flame, and his little eyes were suns."
  - A genuine pre-Christian hymn-fragment. Vahagn ↔ Iranian Verethragna; the "dragon-reaper" (*višapakʿał*) ↔ Gen 1:21 / Ps 74.
  - Also: Artashes and Satenik; Artavazd chained in Masis (H3).
- (b) ***Sasna Tsrer***, four branches:
  - **Sanasar and Baghdasar**, conceived by a princess from a miraculous spring, escape the Assyrian king **Senekerim** (Sennacherib) and found Sasun;
  - Lion Mher; **David of Sasun** against **Msra Melik** (the "king of Egypt", *Msr*);
  - Little Mher, sealed alive in the Rock of Van, waiting to come out at the end of days.
  - The founding story continues **2 Kgs 19:37 / Isa 37:38**: Sennacherib's sons Adrammelech and Sharezer kill him "and escaped into the land of Ararat". Movses already knew this tradition: the Armenian houses traced descent from them (Movses I.23).
  - Christian layer: the "Cross of Battles" talisman; the Virgin.
- *Bible.* (a) MEDIUM-HIGH via Gen 8:4 (Ararat) and Gen 10–11 (Hayk; in E1). (b) MEDIUM: 2 Kgs 19:37, Egypt as the oppressor ↔ Exodus, David vs. a giant ↔ 1 Sam 17. Typological and onomastic.
- *Soul.* HIGH.
- *Base text and tools.* Abeghyan–Yarutiwnean's critical Movses (Tiflis 1913, PD?, verify). Classical Armenian tools: the *Nor Bargirkʿ* (NBHL, 1836–37, PD), digilib.am (**verified 200**, reported content). Thomson's Movses translation (1978/2006, ©). Epic: Armenian Academy editions (©); English, Shalian 1964 and Surmelian 1964 (©, reported). sasna-tsrer.am blocked.
- LLM: Classical Armenian MED-GOOD; Western Armenian dialects MEDIUM-LOW.
- **Hebrew: none found.**
- *Benefit:* (a) Bible MED-HIGH / Soul HIGH; (b) Bible MEDIUM / Soul HIGH. *Recommendation:* the Movses fragments go in E1 (cheap, strong). The epic is a later, bigger project, best checked with an Armenian scholar.

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3. Also considered (one line each)

- **Ossian** (Macpherson, 1760–65): an 18th-c. literary construction loosely based on Gaelic ballads. Exclude; cite as a warning.
- **Oera Linda Book** (Frisian, 1867–72): a forgery. Exclude.
- **Book of Veles** (*Velesova kniga*, surfaced 1950s): a forgery. Exclude.
- **Králové Dvůr and Zelená Hora manuscripts** (Czech, 1817–18; incl. "Libuše's Judgment", a fake Old Czech law poem): forgeries. Exclude.
- **Iolo Morganwg's Barddas** (publ. 1862–74) and the "Third Series" triads in the *Myvyrian Archaiology*: forgeries of druidic lore. Exclude, and check every "Welsh triad" against Bromwich.
- **Kalevala** (Lönnrot 1835/1849) and **Kanteletar**: a 19th-c. composition from the runes. Use SKVR instead (F1).
- **Kalevipoeg** (Kreutzwald 1857–61) and **Lāčplēsis** (Pumpurs 1888): literary national epics. Exclude.
- **Lebor Gabála as history**: it is pseudo-history. Use it as reception (A4).
- **Kensington Runestone** (Minnesota, 1898): a hoax.
- **Simon Grunau's Prussian gods**, the *Sudovian Book*, and Romantic "Baltic pantheons": unreliable.
- **Altabiskarko kantua** and **Iruña-Veleia**: Basque forgeries.
- **Bern zinc tablet** (Gaulish/Latin dedication to Taranis?): its authenticity has been questioned (verify). Exclude pending checking.
- **Snorri's Heimskringla / Ynglinga saga** (Óðinn as a migrating king from Asia): euhemerism, 13th c. A note only.
- **Icelandic family sagas and fornaldarsögur**: 13th–14th-c. prose literature. Out of scope except as context (e.g. the völva in *Eiríks saga rauða* 4).
- **Saxo Grammaticus, *Gesta Danorum*** (Latin, c. 1200): a Latin reworking of Danish legend (the Hamlet source). Classical/Latin survey.
- **Jordanes, *Getica*** (Latin, 551): the Gothic origin from Scandza; mentions Gothic "ancient songs". Latin; note only.
- **Gothic Bible (Wulfila), Old Saxon Heliand, OE Genesis A/B, Saltair na Rann as a whole**: biblical paraphrase. Out of scope as "ancient texts", but worth a reception row (B8, A5).
- **OE elegies** (Wanderer, Seafarer, Wife's Lament, Ruin): Christian but superb "soul" texts. Consider later.
- **Exeter Book riddles** (c. 95): humour and everyday objects; "soul" MEDIUM. Later.
- **Hervarar saga's riddles and *Hlǫðskviða*** (the "Battle of the Goths and Huns"; possibly very old heroic matter): Viking Society free PDF verified listed. Later.
- **Sigurd/Völsung heroic poems of the Edda** (Fáfnismál and others): the dragon-slaying ↔ *tanninim*. Second wave after B1.
- **Book of Taliesin, Y Gododdin**: language too obscure for a reliable LLM-led translation (A12).
- **Táin Bó Fraích, Fled Bricrend, Togail Bruidne Da Derga, Acallam na Senórach**: good Irish texts, second wave or later. The Acallam is 12th-c. and Christian-framed.
- **Irish saints' Lives** (Bethu Brigte etc.): Christian hagiography with pagan residue (Brigit). Low priority.
- **Lepontic, Celtiberian beyond Botorrita**: too fragmentary.
- **Pictish**: symbols, no readable texts.
- **Vainakh (Chechen/Ingush) and Dagestani Nart traditions**: low resources. Cite only.

- **Sámi drums and noaidi texts**: no native texts survive; missionary descriptions only.
- **Lithuanian *Lietuvių liaudies dainynas*** (©) in bulk: too large; only a selected laments set (C2).
- **Russian *dukhovnye stikhi*** beyond the Dove Book: later; Christian.

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4. Access notes (tested 2026-10-21 from this session)

Each test was `curl -s -o /dev/null -m 20 -w "%{http_code}" https://HOST/`, plus sample fetches where noted. "Reset" / "502" mean the egress proxy refused or dropped the tunnel: `connection reset` / `CONNECT tunnel failed, response 502`, with the proxy status logging `ws_closed_mid_exchange` or `connect_rejected`. These are policy blocks for this session; per the proxy README they should not be retried.

Working (verified):

- celt.ucc.ie 200.
  - Sampled Táin I text001.html (Irish text) and the TEI headers of 11 texts.
  - Every header is **[RESTRICTED] "Available with prior consent of the CELT programme for purposes of academic research and teaching only"**. Calder's Auraicept edition is noted as "now in the free domain"; Gray's CMT is © Gray, used by permission.
  - irlpage.html lists 286 Irish entries. Lebor Gabála is present only as Murphy's index (`indexLG.html`).
- aineistot.finlit.fi (SKVR web app) 200; skvr.fi → 301 to it.
  - SKVR.zip: 200, `Content-Length: 128472300`. A range-read of its central directory showed 89,250 entries (89,247 TEI poems + 3 metadata files).
  - raw.githubusercontent.com/sks190/SKVR/master/README.md: 200 (licence **CC BY 4.0**, 89,247 texts, 1564–1939).
  - github.com HTML and the GitHub API for that repo were refused: 403, repo not enabled for the session.
- Old Norse:
  - etext.old.no 200 (Bugge 1867, all poems);
  - www.septentrionalia.net 200 (PDF library: Finnur Jónsson's Eddukvæði, Snorra Edda, *Skjaldedigtning* A1–B2, Hauksbók);
  - heimskringla.no 200 (Völuspá page fetched; it gave 500 once, intermittent);
  - www.menota.org 200; handrit.is 200; www.sagnanet.is 200; onp.ku.dk 302 → onp.php;
  - www.germanic-lexicon-project.org 200;
  - Viking Society PDFs at **http://www.vsnrweb-publications.org.uk/** 200 (the https version fails with a TLS alert): Evans' *Hávamál*, Faulkes' Edda, glossaries.
- app.raa.se/open/runor/ 200 (Runor, a JavaScript app).
- Old English: bosworthtoller.com 200 (entry page fetched); ebeowulf.uky.edu 200 (Electronic Beowulf 5th ed.); oepoetryfacsimile.org 200; heorot.dk 200.
- Old High German and German manuscripts:
  - de.wikisource.org 200 (Wessobrunn raw wikitext fetched; Merseburg page gave 429, rate limit);
  - titus.fkidg1.uni-frankfurt.de 200 (a Titus mirror, OHG pages);
  - www.digitale-sammlungen.de 200; www.e-codices.unifr.ch 200.
- Irish: ogham.celt.dias.ie 200 (OG(H)AM corpus); www.isos.dias.ie 200 (Irish Script on Screen); www.dias.ie 200; corpas.ria.ie 200; www.duchas.ie 200.
- Welsh: www.geiriadur.ac.uk 200 (GPC); mabinogi.net 200; www.library.wales 200.
- Latvian: korpuss.lv 200 (dainas corpus page); lulfmi.lv 200.
- Russian: feb-web.ru 200 (byliny section; cp1251); ru.wikisource.org 200.
- Caucasus and others: www.ironau.ru 200 (Ossetian); www.digilib.am 200; www.matenadaran.am 200; giellatekno.uit.no 200; runeberg.org 200; gutenberg.org 200; archive.org 200; oapen.org 200.
- benyehuda.org 200 (Tchernichovsky's Edda page and lexicon fetched; the `/search` path returned 404 for scripted queries).

Blocked, down or bot-protected (a future session needs these in its allowlist, or a browser):

- **riig.huma-num.fr** (reset, both https and http): the Gaulish corpus.
- **titus.uni-frankfurt.de** (reset; use the fkidg1 mirror).
- **lexlep.univie.ac.at** and univie.ac.at/lexlep (503 or 502).
- **hesperia.ucm.es** (reset): the Celtiberian database.
- **dil.ie / www.dil.ie** (503 "No server is available", an origin outage, not policy): eDIL, essential for Irish. Retry later.
- **codecs.vanhamel.nl** (503).
- **www.doe.utoronto.ca** (reset); doe.artsci.utoronto.ca (Cloudflare "verifying you are human").
- **skaldic.org** (a JS "Checking your browser" page; www.skaldic.org TLS handshake failure).
- **dainuskapis.lv** (Cloudflare "Sorry, you have been blocked", 403); garamantas.lv 403.
- **www.folklore.ee**, regilaul.ee, erlas.folklore.ee, www.kirmus.ee (reset or 502): the Estonian regilaul database.
- **www.lfk.lt**, llti.lt (reset; www.llti.lt is 200).
- **cleasby-vigfusson.marlluslab.com** (502).
- **www.runforum.nordiska.uu.se** (reset): the Rundata download.
- **www.welshprose.org / rhyddiaithganoloesol.caerdydd.ac.uk** (502 or 503): the Middle Welsh prose corpus.

- **corpus.ie** (502); www.thesaurus.dias.ie (502): Thesaurus Palaeohibernicus. Use the PD scans of Stokes & Strachan 1901–03 instead.
- **digital.library.wales** (502).
- **kaino.kotus.fi** (403): Finnish dialect and Karelian dictionaries.
- **sacred-texts.com** (403).
- **poetrytrans.com** (503): Arieh Stav's translations.
- **www.sasna-tsrer.am** (502); **corpus.ossetic-studies.org** (reset); www.osetinsky.ru, www.irislit.ru (502).
- **www.hs-augsburg.de** (Bibliotheca Augustana, reset).
- **lexicon.ff.cuni.cz** (TLS protocol error).
- **www.dainas.lv now redirects to a casino site.** Do not use it.

APIs: SKVR's TEI Publisher app exposes `api/collection/main` and `api/search/facets` (seen in the page source, not tested). The zip is the practical bulk route. CELT has no API; it serves HTML pages per text with a `header.html`.

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5. Sources consulted

- Brief and project files: `translation-guidelines.md` §§1, 2.3, 3, 8; `curated-translation-candidates.md`; `curation-surveys/relevance-survey--2026-10-16.md`, `availability-survey--2026-10-16.md`.
- CELT: https://celt.ucc.ie/irlpage.html ; https://celt.ucc.ie/published/G301012/text001.html ; https://celt.ucc.ie/published/G301012/header.html (and the headers of G106500A, G300010, G300011, G502003, G100033, G109001, G100032, G202001, G303028, G301035) ; https://celt.ucc.ie/indexLG.html (search result).
- SKVR: https://aineistot.finlit.fi/exist/apps/skvr/index.html ; https://raw.githubusercontent.com/sks190/SKVR/master/README.md ; https://aineistot.finlit.fi/exist/rest/db/apps/skvr/data/SKVR.zip ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Suomen_kansan_vanhat_runot ; https://github.com/jakobytes/elias-1848 ; https://oraltradition.org/ecompanion/8620/
- Old Norse: https://heimskringla.no/wiki/V%C3%B6lusp%C3%A1 ; https://etext.old.no/ ; https://www.septentrionalia.net/etexts/ ; https://www.menota.org/forside.xhtml ; http://www.vsnrweb-publications.org.uk/ ; https://onp.ku.dk/ ; https://app.raa.se/open/runor/ ; https://www.runforum.nordiska.uu.se/en/srd/ (search result: ODbL/DbCL) ; https://www.gu.se/en/news/the-vikings-erected-a-runestone-out-of-fear-of-a-climate-catastrophe (Rök 2020).
- OE and OHG: https://ebeowulf.uky.edu/ ; https://bosworthtoller.com/ ; https://de.wikisource.org/wiki/Wessobrunner_Gebet ; https://titus.fkidg1.uni-frankfurt.de/texte/texte2.htm
- Gaulish: https://riig.huma-num.fr/ (blocked; search results on the project) ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Larzac_tablet ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chamali%C3%A8res_tablet ; https://archaeology.org/news/2025/01/17/rare-example-of-written-gaulish-found-in-roman-curse-tablet/ ; https://www.thehistoryblog.com/archives/72852
- Irish law and LGE (search results): https://codecs.vanhamel.nl/Cr%C3%ADth_gablach ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Corpus_Iuris_Hibernici ; https://www.brepolsonline.net/doi/pdf/10.1484/J.Peri.3.573 ; https://codecs.vanhamel.nl/Lebor_gab%C3%A1la_%C3%89renn_(M%C3%ADniugud) ; https://celt.ucc.ie/LGintro.pdf
- Ogam: https://ogham.celt.dias.ie/
- Latvian: https://korpuss.lv/en/id/Latvju-dainas ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cabinet_of_Folksongs ; https://garamantas.lv/en
- Estonian: https://folklore.ee/regilaul/andmebaas/?ln=en (search result: 92,134 texts) ; https://keeljakirjandus.ee/?p=36412
- Caucasus: https://press.princeton.edu/books/hardcover/9780691170404/tales-of-the-narts ; https://jfr.sitehost.iu.edu/review.php?id=2093 ; https://languagelog.ldc.upenn.edu/nll/?p=55489 ; https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Daredevils_of_Sassoun ; https://dspace.nla.am/handle/123456789/12905 ; https://www.ironau.ru/
- Hebrew translations: https://benyehuda.org/read/3803 (Tchernichovsky, "מן האדה האיסלנדית": Baldrs draumar, Alvíssmál) ; https://benyehuda.org/lexicon/02047.php (Tchernichovsky bibliography: "1930 ,קטעים נבחרים" (קלולה: קטעים נבחרים) ; https://www.steimatzky.co.il/015500155 and https://booksefer.co.il/ (Stav, 2009 ,*שירת הצפון*; search results) ; https://yaelsela.wordpress.com/2010/05/20/hebrew_translations_of_classics_stav/ (Stav's translations list) ; https://www.nli.org.il/ar/authorities/987007289710405171 (NLI heading "מבינוגיון").
- Proxy diagnostics: `$HTTPS_PROXY/__agentproxy/status` (recentRelayFailures), `/root/.ccr/README.md`.